

**Bhoodan & Gramdan
in
Orissa**

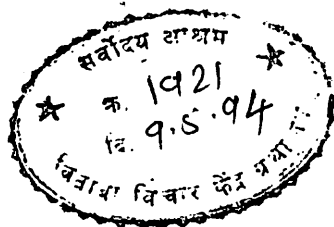
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**T. P. Singh
and his
Associate**

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BHOODAN & GRAMDAN IN ORISSA

A SOCIAL SCIENTIST'S ANALYSIS

[The First Inter-disciplinary Study of India's
Famous Land-Gift Movement]



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Edited by
T. P. SINGH
AND HIS
ASSOCIATE

Sarva Seva Sangh Prakashan
RAJGHAT: VARANASI- 1

BHOODAN & GRAMDAN IN ORISSA

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T. P. SINGH AND HIS ASSOCIATE

1973

Price : **Rs. 10-00**
 Sh. 20-00
 \$ 3-00

Publishers : SARVA SEVA SANGH PRAKASHAN
 RAJGHAT, VARANASI (India)

Edition : FIRST ; 1000

Printers : MANOHAR PRESS
 JATANBAR, VARANASI

Foreword

The Gandhian movement in India faced one of its worst crisis in early 1948. Gandhi was murdered on 30th January, that year. Stalwart Congress leaders who were known as Gandhi's closest associates were no longer pursuing his path. They had, instead, taken over the reins of the Government. Gandhi himself, it may be recalled, did not have much faith in the establishment of the government and had grave doubts if it could at all bring in any radical change in the country. He was sure, on the other hand, that nothing short of a revolutionary transformation of the social, economic and political structure of the nation would have served the purpose. Gandhi had, therefore, tailored many plans for ushering in such a revolution. The first was to take a trip to Pakistan in order to try again—and this time with success—to change the political structure of the sub-continent. The other was to bring to fruition the aspiration of the Indian village communities by enabling them to set up six hundred thousand 'mini' republics to provide the real basis of the Indian polity. They were to be charged with the responsibility of redistribution of all land and on the basis of such fundamental structural changes to build an altogether new typology of a planning movement in India. All these radical programmes were, however, to be brought to ground not through force but through non-violence—a method by which Gandhi had already fought his first battle for colonial freedom. It was now to provide the basic methodology of the post-colonial revolution as well. The struggle for the emancipation of the Indian masses were thus to continue. Violence was to be abhorred. A radically new structure of polity and society was to emerge. At a time when Gandhi was sorting out his plans for these Herculean tasks, he was killed. The Gandhian movement, naturally, fell in a stupor. It was in doldrums.

II

In this period of crisis the movement suddenly found—strange but true—a new impetus. It found a new leader; it established a new organization and adopted a new programme one that was Gandhi's priority for social revolution in India, namely that of land-reforms for structural change. The leader was Vinoba Bhave, the organization was Sarva Seva Sangh and the movement, known by a new name like Julius Nyerere's 'Ujamma', was called Sarvodaya. The programme it took to ground was known as Bhoodan-Gramdan.

The immediate task of the Bhoodan Gramdan movement were, to say the least, the redistribution of land among the landless, the fulfilment of the spirit of land reform 'acts' and the establishment of a single institutional entity to which all people of a village, irrespective of their class, caste, religion, rank and strata would belong. 'Bhoodan' the first phase of the movement came first. It envisaged that every landowner would part 1/6th of his land for redistribution to the landless. In May 1952 after a year's trial the Bhoodan movement was further radicalised and the new phase of 'Gramdan' came into being. The formula now was that 75% of the population of a village (or be it of a block or of a district) owning 51% of land of the area were to be persuaded to part with their proprietary rights in favour of legally constituted Gramsabhas (the village council); and 1/20th of the land of every land owner was thereafter to be available for redistribution among the landless in a manner to be decided by the Gramsabha. The decisions of the village community were to be final in all other matters of the village government as well as would entail ipsofacto transfer of all land to the Gramsabha.

A 'gram kosh' or a 'Community chest' built on the basis of subscription of the villagers e.g. the 1/40th of the income of every earner was to provide the initial capital for village or area development. Later on, the movement grew beyond the village limits. It was decided that if 75% of the population of a block and of a district owning 51% of the land had similarly

agreed to sign up a new unit of decision making what has now come to be known as the 'Prakhand dan'¹ and 'Zila-dan'² units would come into being.

The movement grew in rapid strides and provided an unique, global mechanism for voluntary transfer of the means of production to the local community. All these, the transference of legal rights, the establishment of community institutions and the pooling of community resources were to be achieved without blood-shed and by means of non-violent, democratic persuasion. Socialism of a new type was thus to emerge from the roots of the rural society.

The movement made rapid progress in the fifties and the sixties. More than 3,00,000 acres of land were distributed by 1969 in Bihar alone.³ In Orissa too the movement came of age. In Gunpur sub-division, in the district of Koraput, acute land hunger led to a spectacular Satyagraha in 1950 and offered a great impetus to the movement. By 1953 and 1954 workers of all political parties had joined the fray. They came forward to lend their mite to the drive for collection of land in every district of the state. Vinoba finally crossed over into Orissa on January 26, 1955 to lead the movement himself. Welcomed by the Chief Minister of the State he was presented with 1 lakh and 22000 acres of lands given away by 40,000 donors. Ninetythree villages were declared as Gramdan.

III

Naturally, such a movement drew its own critics. Quite a few of them were ruthless in voicing their doubts about the validity of the concepts, theories and functions of Sarvodaya.

1. **PRAKHAND DAN** : If at least 75 per cent of the total population in a block excluding the town folk, or 85 per cent of the revenue villages of block have come under Gramdan, the whole block would be declared as Prakhand -dan.
2. **ZILA-DAN** : If all the blocks in a district declare Parkhand--dan the district becomes a Zila--dan.
3. S. Dasgupta, A Great Society of Small Communities, Sarva Seva Sangh Prakashan, Varanasi (1968), P. 28

Two of these need special mention namely, those who were of the opinion that violence alone could have led to such structural changes and others who belonged to the orthodox school of non-violence. While the former found in the movement a counter revolutionary upsurge the others--the orthodox school of non-violence saw in it a coercive endeavour aimed at bringing in a communitarian society of the collective model. The critics in Orissa were, however, the most trenchant. Although their criticisms were not based on any theoretical assumptions they challenged the moral basis of the entire movement as also its modus operandi. The transactions in Balasore and Koraput came under a special volley of attack. The methods of obtaining land gift, motivations for the same, the methods of redistribution of donated land and even the 'conduct' of the Sarvodaya workers were challenged.

The question was what could one do with such criticism, challenges and brickbats? The Gandhian movement which went into temporary disarray in the late forties had certainly rediscovered its soul in the development of this countrywide 'programme' of social and economic emancipation. Land redistribution was Gandhi's priority. Non-violence was his method. The land problem was also the most explosive of all those which had stared the country in the face. The Gandhians had, thus, taken--they thought--great stride towards the solution of one of the most malignant evils of the country. But there were the doubting Thomases, not only in Orissa but all over country. What could one do with these criticism and doubts?

Just ignore them? Or empirically examine the challenges and draw from them such lessons as are found valid? The present treatise is an endeavour towards the latter. It provides a scientific examination of the working of the movement in a few selected districts of a specific State, Orissa. Having taken note of the criticisms made in Orissa, Shri Jayaprakash Narayan, one of the foremost leaders of the Sarvodaya movement had accordingly appointed a high power team to examine the working of the movement, as mentioned above, and to submit

a report for public use. The team consisted of a number of distinguished social scientists who—barring the convener himself—were in no way connected with the Bhoodan Gramdan movement of the country. They were to make an objective appraisal of its working. The terms of reference of the team were the following :

1. To inquire into the socio-economic milieu in which the Bhoodan Gramdan movement has been operating with special reference to caste, community, socio-economic values and patterns of land-ownership, tenancy and land utilization.

2. To ascertain the motivations of the donors of land in Bhoodan or Gramdan.

3. To examine the methods of distribution of lands obtained in Bhoodan or Gramdan and to find out whether it was done in conformity with the principles of the movement, and

4. To examine the activities and conduct of the workers associated with the Bhoodan--Gramdan or Sarvodaya movement and determine whether there were any deviations from the accepted norms of the movement.

The report that follows has been vested by the team although it is finally written by the convener Dr. T. P. Singh. A distinguished economist in his own right, he has also been an active participant in the freedom movement of the country. The report is an elaborate one. It tells a story which is the best to pass on to our readers without any further comment and for their impartial scrutiny. One word more, before I close.

A dynamic movement like this, which seeks to bring in a fundamental revolution is not easy to evaluate. Even if it can be done, there are questions : Can such a movement, for example, be evaluated by its contemporary critics ? Or should it be left to history to do that ? And again : has any such movement, any where, in the world ever been evaluated ? And do we, accordingly, know the method by which one can conduct such evaluations ? The questions are difficult to answer.

Yet one has to go on with the work. There are, however, probably only two ways of accomplishing the task. The first is to make a multilateral assessment of the successes of such movements in a comparative manner; by cross—checking the net gains of the movement vis-a-vis those which have been carried on in other areas of the country or of the globe. To do that one would need to find out whether the Bhoodan-Gramdan movement has been able to distribute more land and to fulfil more of its stated objectives than what its 'alternatives' have done in this country or abroad.

The other method is to analyse the movement unilaterally. This is what we have precisely attempted to do here in this report. We have thus followed the second and, naturally, a less satisfactory 'method' for the achievement of our goal. The reasons are obvious.

It is for the readers to judge how far the story that the report unravels provides a worthwhile exercise !

Gandhian Institute of Studies

Rajghat, Varanasi

8-8-73

Sugata Dasgupta

Director

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

A study team under the chairmanship of Prof. B. Misra was appointed by Shri Jayaprakash Narayan, with the following eminent social scientists as its members :

1. Dr. B. Misra

Dean, Faculty of Agriculture
Orissa University of Agriculture and Technology
Bhubaneshwar

2. Dr. S. K. Srivastava

Malaviya Professor of Sociology and
Head of the Department of Sociology
Banaras Hindu University
Varanasi

3. Dr. Sachchidanand

Professor of Sociology (now Director)
A. N. Sinha Institute of Social Sciences
Patna

4. Dr. L. K. Mahapatra

Professor and Head of the
Department of Anthropology
Utkal University
Bhubaneshwar

5. Dr. T. P. Singh

Senior Research Fellow
Gandhian Institute of Studies
Rajghat
Varanasi

The study team had a number of meetings and discussions at Bhubaneshwar and Bijapur between 13th and 19th March, 1970, on the method of research to be adopted and schedules and questionnaires to be used. Members of the team visited the sample villages. Shri Hanuman Prasad, Research Fellow in Economics Department of the Gandhian Institute of Studies was present in all the above meetings and also visited the sample villages. He assisted in the tabulation work also.

The field-work was done by a research team on behalf of the study team. This consisted of three Oriya speaking investigators who were accompanied by me and Shri L. M. Chandola of the Gandhian Institute of Studies. Shri Chandola supervised the investigators, and interviewed the Block Development officers. He was very much helpful in tabulation work.

After tabulation and analysis of data the report was prepared by the author. While preparing the draft report Shri L. M. Chandola was quite a help to him and he worked as an associate with him. Copies of this draft report were then circulated to the members of the team for their comments and suggestions.

A copy of the report was also sent to Prof. Sugata Dasgupta (now the Director) of the Gandhian Institute, who was at that time teaching at the London School of Economics. He sent his useful comments and suggestions, which were later on considered. While the report was being finalised, a meeting of the study team was held on February 8, 1971, at the Gandhian Institute of Studies, Varanasi. The present book has been written on the basis of the author's draft report and the comments and suggestions made at the meeting.

The author expresses his thanks to Prof. B. Misra and the other members of the team for their comments and suggestions at different levels.

Shri Jayaprakash Narayan, Shri Nabakrushna Chaudhuri and Shri Manmohan Chaudhary deserve the author's thanks for the valuable interest they took in the completion of this study.

T. P. Singh

BHOODAN AND GRAMDAN IN ORISSA

CONTENTS

1. The Problem	1
2. Type and Method of Research Used	14
3. Socio-Economic Milieu	25
4. Participation and Donation in Bhoodan/Gramdan	40
5. Distribution of Bhoodan/ Gramdan Land	27
6. Village Institutions	79
7. Role of Bhoodan/Gramdan Workers and Deviations	94
8. Summary of Findings and Recommendations	121
9. Appendices 1 to 11	128 to 144

1

The Problem

Measures for the Landless

Alongside efforts to ensure social justice by doing away with parasitic intermediaries in the land system and to encourage economic efficiency by providing ownership rights to tenants several measures for landless labourers were proposed and to some extent implemented during the successive Five Year Plans. These were : (i) Schemes of land re-distribution for cultivation; (ii) Provision of plots of land to landless agricultural labourers for constructing their houses; (iii) Giving of contracts of small schemes of construction direct to labour cooperatives; (iv) Minimum wages; (v) Works programmes for irrigation, afforestation, soil conservation, drainage, land reclamation, improvement of communications, and (vi) Programmes for the development of village and small industries to provide employment to the landless.

The problem of agricultural labourers is part of the wider problem of un-employment and under-employment in rural areas. All the Five-Year Plans included proposals for the settlement of agricultural labourers on land and for their protection against ejection from homestead. That not much progress was

made in the schemes for land settlement was noted later by the Planning Commission itself.

“The programme of ceilings set out in the Plans was diluted in implementation. There were deficiencies in the law and delays in its enactment and implementation resulting in large evasions. Several States had made provisions for disregarding transfers made after a specific date, but often these provisions proved to be ineffective and not much surplus land has been available for re-distribution. The main object of ceilings to re-distribute land to the landless at a reasonable price on a planned basis has thus been largely defeated.”¹

In the State of Orissa, the Act of 1965 lays down a ceiling of 20-80 acres per individual holder. However, it has yet to be enforced.

Gandhiji, it may be recalled, was for re-distribution of all lands. There was in his scheme no question of compensation; land was to go to the tiller of the soil; only so long as the cultivator or his heirs tilled it was the land to be in their possession, or else it was to revert to the community. The community in his opinion was and should be the owner of the land.²

Land hunger in the country and the agrarian crisis in Telengana prompted the followers of Gandhiji to make a serious attempt at achieving the objective on a voluntary basis. For this purpose Vinobaji visited Telengana in April 1951.

Persistent agrarian tension had broken out into

1. Planning Commission, The Fourth Five Year Plan—A Draft Outline, Delhi (1966), p. 131.

2. Harijan, 25.8.1940.

large scale violence in Telengana of Andhra Pradesh. Vinobaji decided to visit it. When Vinobaji entered Telengana in April 1951, the uppermost thought in his mind was the challenge of widespread violence resorted to both by the people and the Government. The situation was serious. If society was to be saved from disruption and eventual self-destruction, it was essential to find out a non-violent and peaceful remedy to meet the situation. At one of his meetings few landless peasants requested him to get them some land to cultivate. Responding to it, one Shri Ram Chandra Reddi of village Pochampalli made a gift of land on the spot. This was the birth of Bhoodan which Vinobaji subsequently built into a truly revolutionary concept. Besides re-distribution of land as a solution of the land problem in India, the aim of Bhoodan and Gramdan has been much wider and deeper in scope from the very beginning. He began his *padayatra* for collection of land. The Bhoodan movement soon developed into a demand on land owners for one sixth share in their land. Later on it broadened its scope to removal of landlessness in the country. Finally, it set itself the goal of eradicating private ownership in land. This is Gramdan. The renunciation of private property in land on a mass scale born of the realisation that all land in a village belongs to the village community as a whole is the latest and most significant development of Bhoodan movement.

The Planning Commission says, "The ultimate goal of the Gramdan movement is Gram Swaraj. It is based on the concept that a village community as a whole constitutes a big family. Love and non-violence will be the basis of all acts of the community operation

and equitable sharing together will be its guiding principles. The land in a village would be common property or, rather more exactly, property held in trust by the village community on behalf of God. The adults in the community would form the Gramsabha managing the lands and the multifarious affairs of the community on its behalf.”¹

The first Gramdan was offered to Vinobaji by Mangroth village in the district of Hamirpur in Uttar Pradesh on 24th May, 1952. The second Gramdan occurred, three years after, in a village in Orissa by the name of Manipur. It was the third Gramdani village, Akili (district Ganjam in Orissa), which made a real impact. The message of Gramdan thereafter spread from one place to another. Seven hundred villages were received in Koraput and other districts in Orissa. The sceptics attributed this to the susceptibility of Adivasis to the emotional appeal of the campaign. They were, however, silenced when relatively prosperous and well-to-do villages joined Gramdan.

There are three stages in Gramdan : (i) the inhabitants of a village agreeing to gift away their land; (ii) recognition of the village as Gramdan village on receipt of gift papers; and (iii) its registration as a Gramdan village in Government records.

The concept of Gramdan has undergone various changes according to the need of situation. In Mangroth it meant gifting away by the whole village. The Prabandh Samiti of Sarva Seva Sangh, at its meeting held in Yelwal on September 28, 1957, decided that if about 80% of the land-owners of a village were pre-

1. Government of India, Planning Commission, *Gramdan Movement*, New Delhi (1964), p. 5.

pared to give up the right of ownership and not less than 50% of the total land was gifted away, the village would be bound to be a Gramdani village. If owing to scarcity of land the landless people who could not give away much in the way of land, were prepared to gift away their other incomes, then the village would be recognized as a '*Gram Parivar*'.

It was hoped that Gramdan would lead to a fuller development of corporate village life leading to economic betterment and all round progress of the people of the village. A psychological climate would thus be created for peaceful solution of the land problem in the country. Non-violent technique and voluntary effort were the two fundamental characteristics of the movement. The ethical approach was combined with practical economic appeal to promote a just social order based on co-operation and self-help.

In the beginning the term 'village' meant a revenue village and the donation of entire land of the village to the Gramsabha was considered necessary for Gramdan. The land thus received was to be re-distributed among the villagers according to the needs of each family. People of the Gramdan village had no right to sell or mortgage their land. In Bihar, however, even the hamlets (*Tola*) of a revenue village were treated as Grams for purposes of Gramdan. If 80 per cent of the land-owners of a hamlet donated their entire land and if the land as donated formed 50% of the total land of the village, it was considered a Gramdan. The landless of the village were to be given a part of donated land to be drawn into the process of Gramdan.

The Gramdan worker had to face a major diffi-

culty in the matter of re-distribution of land. A person who surrendered ownership in order to join Gramdan had to make over possession to the Gramsabha, which then had to re-distribute the land equitably among the large, the medium and small holders and the landless alike. Villagers were willing enough to renounce ownership of their entire holding, but were reluctant to surrender possession. The reluctance was more marked on the part of persons with large holdings. Indeed, a certain amount of fear of this aspect of Gramdan was noticeable among them. Clearly, they were not yet ready for that degree of equality which the movement envisaged. In order to allay their fears and to assure them that the movement was not designed to harm their interests the concept of Gramdan was modified to bring it into accord with the realities of the situation.

Vinobaji now demanded relinquishment of the possession of only $1/20$ th of one's holding, leaving the possession of the remaining $19/20$ ths and heritable rights over this with the landowner, who was further assured that neither he nor his descendents would be deprived of their land without their consent. Thus a new concept of Sulabh Gramdan was evolved. A distinction was made between ownership and possession of land. While a person joining Gramdan must surrender ownership of all his land, he was not required to give up possession of more than $1/20$ ths of his holding.

At the Raipur Conference of the Sarva Seva Sangh held in December 1963 five basic conditions were laid down for Sulabh Gramdan :

1. Giving away a minimum of one-twentieth of one's cultivable land for the landless of the village.

2. Vesting the ownership of all his land in the Gram-sabha of the village, the right over 19/20th of this to remain unaffected subject to the condition that this land shall not be sold or mortgaged but can be transferred in full or in part to the Gramsabha or to any family which has joined the Gramsabha.

3. Contributing to the Gram-Kosh one-fortieth (or any portion fixed by the Gramsabha) of the produce of one's land calculated after deducting the land revenue.

4. One having no land but making a living by other means to contribute one-thirtieths (or any portion fixed by the Gramsabha) of his monthly income to the Gram-kosh either in cash or in labour.

The Gram-kosh was to be the community fund to be used for purposes of providing relief to the destitutes and the orphans, providing educational facilities and establishing or renovating rural industries.

5. One adult member from each family of the Gramdan village or all the adults of the village to be members of the Gramsabha which would function either with unanimity or with consensus.

In their anxiety to get as many Gramdans as possible, and failing to get adequate response from landowners in revenue villages, some workers in Bihar approached small hamlets and persuaded them to join Gramdan. Although this did swell the number of Gramdans, it was not conducive to the larger interests of land revolution.

Vinobaji thereupon gave a call for 'Prakhand-dan' (Gramdan of all villages in a Prakhand or Block) on October 23, 1965 at Katihar. Initially Prakhand Dan was considered complete only when all the villages of a Block had come under Gramdan. Later, however, it was decided that if at least 75 percent of the total population (excluding the womenfolk) or 85 percent of the revenue villages of a Block joined Gramdan, the whole Block would be treated as having been covered. When all the blocks in a district had been thus covered it became Ziladan.

This movement was started in Orissa in January 1952. In Gunpur sub-division in the district of Koraput acute land hunger had expressed in Satyagraha in the year 1950. In the year 1953-54 constructive workers and workers of all political parties in Orissa joined hands in a drive to collect Bhoodan land in every district. When Vinobaji crossed over into Orissa at Lakhannath on January 26, 1955 after a twentyfive-day tour of West Bengal he was welcomed by the then Chief Minister of Orissa and was presented with one lac and twenty-two thousand acres of land given away by forty thousand donors and ninety-three villages as Gramdan. His first *Padayatra* in Orissa lasted till October 1, 1955. The second came in August 1963.

Balasore and Koraput districts came on top with their contribution as follows¹:

<i>Name of District. No. of Bhoodan villages, No. of Gramdan villages.</i>		
Balasore	2560	1284
Koraput	1976	2850

(Source : A communication from the Secretary, Orissa Bhoodan Yajna Samiti, Bhubaneswar, dated 6-11-1970).

1. See Appendices 1 & 2.

Various reasons are ascribed for the success of the movement in those two districts. The extreme ideas of communism prevalent in the neighbouring States of West Bengal and Andhra Pradesh have been influencing them. The district of Balasore is situated near the border of West Bengal and it is much under the influence of Vaishnavism preached by Shri Chaitanya. Prior to British occupation this area underwent a social and cultural revolution. The spirit of casteism, untouchability and communalism is rather weak there. The neighbouring district of Midnapur in West Bengal is famous for its effective role in the terrorist movement and in the 1942 struggle. Generally, the border people accept the challenge from outside. These two neighbouring districts, though poor, made an effort to meet the challenge by accepting Bhoodan-Gramdan.

The social structure of the *Adivasi* villages in the district of Koraput is close to the conception of Gramdan. Till recently there was a headman (Nayak or Mandal) in each village. Therefore, a Gramsabha would be acceptable to the *adivasis*. There is traditional spirit of sharing both in joy and sorrow in *adivasi* societies. They jointly take part in dancing, feasting in common festivals throughout the year. There is also the spirit of self-sufficiency in the *adivasi* villages which is also a keynote of the principle of Gramdan.

Besides this, enthusiastic workers were available in both the districts who could make efforts to accelerate the movement.

This movement really checked violent movements in the State of Orissa. After reaching a certain peak it started tapering off. This has created a situation

of violence and some violence of Naxalite type has been reported in this long time peaceful state. This shows what an important role was played by this movement in keeping violence away.

Controversies which led to this study

The State Government helped the movement with grants and in other ways. The Orissa Bhoodan Yajna Act of 1953 gave statutory sanction to redistribution of land received in Bhoodan. But the White Paper of August-September 1969 described, inter alia, that "... Shri Nabakrishna Chaudhury, Leader and Chairman of the Left United Front, openly advocated violent Naxalite policies and in giving his blessing to agitational movement urged upon his followers to work in close co-operation with the Socialist Unity Centre and the Ultra Leftist extremists known as Naxalites."¹

It was reported that "... the State Government has been 'concerned' because the Bhoodan workers are also associated with 'anti-social activities' in Koraput district (adjoining Andhra Pradesh) where Naxalites are active... The Collector of Koraput district is understood to have brought to the notice of the Government.... 'shady dealings and fraud in both declarations of land donation and land distribution.' He has reportedly complained that there was also favouritism in land distribution, most of which has gone only to the relatives of Bhoodan workers. In some cases, the Bhoodan *amins* had persuaded villagers to donate land under the pretext of getting them Govern-

1. Government of Orissa, Home Department, Review of Law and Order situation in Orissa. August-September 1969, White Paper, p. 1.

ment subsidy for purchase of bullocks and agricultural equipments".¹

The Finance Department of the same State Government did not share the view expressed in the White Paper. It said that under "the Orissa Bhoodan Yajna Act, 1953 till October 1969 a total extent of land measuring 9,66,898.73 acres have been donated to the Orissa Bhoodan Yajna Samiti out of which 5,47,981.59 acres have been distributed to the grantees. A sum of Rs. 39,23,231 has been sanctioned by the Government so far to the Orissa Bhoodan Yajna Samiti as grant-in-aid of which Rs. 29,980,11 was meant for purchase of bullocks, seeds, reclamation of waste land by the beneficiaries while Rs. 9,25,220 was for maintenance of establishment and other contingent expenditure of the Bhoodan organisation. Out of the non-recurring grant sanctioned the Bhoodan Yajna Samiti has distributed a sum of Rs. 29,53,121 among the beneficiaries till the 31st October, 1969."²

But even so the charges made in the White Paper were too serious to be ignored by the organizers of the movement. That doubts were being cast in authoritative circles about the activities of Bhoodan workers and also about the conduct of the movement as such was a matter of grave concern to them. In order to obtain an objective appraisal of the whole situation by an impartial body Shri Jayaprakash Narayan appointed the present Committee to go into the matter. It was hoped that such a study might throw light on the

1. 'The Hindustan Times', November 11, 1969.

2. Government of Orissa Finance Department, "On Economic conditions and the Developmental Activities in Orissa" 1970, p. 42.

factors inhibiting the implementation of Bhoodan Gramdan movement, its limitations and problems and might lead to suggestions regarding corrective measures for the future.

Summary

After Indian independence several measures were proposed and partly implemented for the landless agricultural labourers during the successive Plans. These were schemes of (i) land re-distribution for cultivation; (ii) provision of plots of land to the landless agricultural labourers for constructing houses for their living; (iii) giving of contract of small schemes of construction direct to labour co-operatives; (iv) minimum wages; (v) works programme and (vi) programme for the development of village and small industries.

These were of hardly any benefit to the landless agricultural labourers. An agrarian crisis started in Telengana in 1951. Vinobaji visited the area. Some one donated land to Vinobaji in a meeting and the concept of Bhoodan was born. Soon after he launched the Bhoodan Movement and made an appeal for country-wide donation of land. Later on he asked for one-sixth of land of the landholder.

In 1952 May Vinoba on his *padayatra* was offered a Gramdan of Mangroth in Uttar Pradesh. In this the whole village joined and all the landholders donated all their land which was equitably distributed among the villagers. This type of Gramdan was not making satisfactory progress. Therefore the concept of Sulabh Gramdan was introduced in which 75 percent of the population were expected to join and ownership of 51 percent of the village was expected to vest the proprietary rights in the Gramsabha. One

twentieth of their land was to be re-distributed to the landless and needy households of the village. A Gramsabha and a *gramkosh* were to be constituted in the Gramdani villages. Later on for various reasons efforts were made for Prakhand-dans and Zila-dans.

The movement made a good progress in Orissa. In this State it was most successful in the districts of Balasore and Koraput.

A controversy started in Orissa regarding the method of obtaining Bhoodan-Gramdan, motivations for the same, method of re-distribution of donated land and conduct of the Bhoodan Gramdan workers. Therefore, a study team was appointed by Shri Jayaprakash Narayan with the following terms of reference :

- (a) To understand and note the socio-economic milieu in which the Bhoodan-Gramdan movement has been carried out with special reference to caste, community, socio-economic values and land-ownership and utilisation patterns.
- (b) To ascertain the chief motivations of the donor of Bhoodan-Gramdan.
- (c) To inquire into the methods of distribution of Bhoodan and Gramdan land and to find out whether it is done in accordance with the relevant principles and rules of the movement.
- (d) To inquire into the nature of the activities of Bhoodan-Gramdan (or Sarvodaya) workers and find out if there are any deviations from the accepted norms of the movement. ●

Type and Method of Research Used

This research was mainly conceived on the empirical model. The auxiliary and secondary data relating to socio-economic milieu, land reforms, government measures for the benefit of agricultural labourers, and history of Bhoodan and Gramdan work were collected from gazetteers, census handbook, government and Bhoodan reports.

Multi-stage sampling was used in the research design. In the first stage two districts, Balasore and Koraput, were selected because much more Bhoodan and Gramdan work had been done there than in other districts of the state. In the second stage five centres were selected, one in non-tribal area and four in the tribal areas. They were selected on the same basis as the district, viz. the extent of the work of Bhoodan and Gramdan. Only one centre was selected in non-tribal areas as all of them were generally of same type. It was situated in Baliapal block of Balasore district. The second centre which spread over two blocks was in a tribal area. It consisted of two villages, Bijapur (successful) in Jhorigaon block and Koilari (unsuccessful) in Dabugaon block. In this centre local leadership was available to the movement. Freedom fighters who had not sought government jobs, were glad to

have this opportunity to work for the people and plunged into the Bhoodan-Gramdan movement. Another tribal cluster situated in Boipariguda block which had earlier been headed by Sarvodaya workers, had benefited by the presence of Sarva Seva Sangh. The centre in Bondhugaon block had been covered by the integrated development programme of Khadi Commission. The centre in Nandpur block had nothing special. No real differences in the four tribal centres have, however, been found.

The villages or clusters of villages in the five centres were selected in the third stage. One of the villages or cluster of villages in each centre was selected, where Bhoodan-Gramdan work was believed to be fairly successful and another where it was not. A successful village or cluster of villages was considered to be one where (i) Bhoodan-Gramdan land had been distributed, (ii) a Gramsabha had been constituted and (iii) a Gram-kosh was functioning. An unsuccessful village or cluster of villages was one where Bhoodan/Gramdan land had not been distributed or where much of distributed land had reverted to the donors and where neither Gram-sabha nor Gram-kosh was functioning. Each village or cluster of villages consisted of around 100 households and had almost the same caste composition. The differences in the successful and unsuccessful villages or clusters have been dealt with at their respective places.

In the fourth stage household whose heads were to be interviewed were selected on a random basis. They were stratified into four categories : (i) donors; (ii) donees; (iii) land-owning non-donors and (iv) landless households. There were some Sahukars who

Table-1A

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

	CLUSTER I		CLUSTER II		CLUSTER III		CLUSTER IV		CLUSTER V		Total Sample
	Total Sample %	household	Total Sample %	household	Total Sample %	household	Total Sample %	household	Total Sample %	household	Sample
Donor	7	5 73.45	20	5 25.00	36	9 25.00	29	6 20.68	15	5 33.33	30
Donee	28	7 25.00	12	5 41.67	20	5 25.00	39	7 17.95	27	7 25.00	31
Land-owning non-donor	76	12 16.00	55	12 21.18	42	8 19.51	14	5 35.71	52	11 21.00	48
Land-less agricultural labourer	6	5 84.33	31	8 25.00	10	5 50.00	10	5 50.00	-	- -	23
Sahukar	-	- -	-	- -	-	- -	2	2 100.00	-	- -	2
Total	117	29 25.00	118	30 25.00	108	27 25.00	94	25 25.00	94	23 25.00	134

Total No. of households 531

Table 1-B

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

	CLUSTER I		CLUSTER II		CLUSTER III		CLUSTER IV		CLUSTER V		Total Sample					
	Total Sample No.	%	Total Sample No.	%	Total Sample No.	%	Total Sample No.	%	Total Sample No.	%						
Donor	25	5	20.00	60	15	25.00	19	5	26.32	63	12	19.04	26	6	25.00	43
Donee	8	5	62.50	26	6	23.08	9	5	53.05	20	5	25.00	27	7	25.00	28
Land-owning non-donor	32	6	23.52	53	12	22.64	66	12	18.19	20	5	25.00	46	9	19.60	44
Landless agricultural labourer	35	7	20.00	13	5	38.46	16	5	31.25	5	5	100.00	8	5	62.50	27
Sahukar	2	2	100.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	2
Total	102	25	25.00	152	38	25.00	110	27	25.00	108	27	25.00	107	27	25.00	144

Total No. of households 579

formed a class by themselves. The selected households formed 25% of the total number of households in each village (Tables I-A & I-B). If the number of households in some stratum happened to be very large or very small, the percentage was varied to make the sample representative. A minimum of five households in each stratum was the norm. However, if the number of households in any stratum was five or less, all the households were selected for interviewing their heads. The *sahukars* were interviewed separately.

Variables :

Four variables were considered in this study. They were: (i) land-ownership; (ii) caste; (iii) educational standard ; and (iv) membership of political parties.

Research Personnel :

Three Oriya speaking investigators trained in social sciences and with experience of survey work were appointed for field work. They had no connections with the Sarvodaya movement. Their work was supervised by two senior members of the Gandhian Institute of Studies. The latter also interviewed the workers and the government officials.

Questionnaire :

The questions, attitudinal and of opinion type, were so framed as to be simple, direct and precise which simple tribals would easily understand and answer. Open ended questions were avoided.

Besides questionnaire the investigators were given interview guides also. The questionnaire and the interview guides should be taken together as one set. Otherwise, same questions as on the motivations of

the donors or on the performance of the workers, may be taken as merely "leading questions", which as such might have distorted the results. But actually, the investigators were instructed to ask the questions not in the form existing in the body of the donor's questionnaire. They were advised to take care that the interviewees did not derive any definite suggestions as to the desirability of an answer. It is quite possible that even this precaution might not have been always rigorously followed. However, the distortion, if any, is believed to be of marginal importance and may be overlooked in assessing the conclusions arrived at.

Difficulties faced by the Field Staff :

The Bhoodan office at Bhubaneshwar named a set of three villages, Dalua, Routraipur and Chidasungamuhan as successful Bhoodan-Gramdan villages. The permanent workers and an ex-Bhoodan Nivedaka of the Balasore district when interrogated by a member of the team corroborated this statement. However, when the research team visited the villages for field work the workers were evasive and suggested that the team go to a village about eight to ten miles south of Baliapal. The team thereupon contacted the Bhoodan office at Balasore only to be told that the suggested village was neither Bhoodani nor Gramdani. The Block personnel, busy in Panchayat elections, had no time to spare for the team. Eventually, finding the team determined to go ahead with its task, the Bhoodan-Gramdan workers reluctantly introduced it to the villagers. In Dalua no progress had been made beyond the declaration of Bhoodan-Gramdan, though it was registered in Government record as a Gramdani

village. Registration, it may be mentioned, is effected only when the distribution records duly completed are submitted to the Tehsildar. Most of the other two villages named by the Bhoodan office had gone under water of the river Subarnarekha and the villagers, had migrated to different villages, only a very small number remaining behind. This made it necessary for the team to find other successful villages in consultation with the District Bhoodan office.

List of Sample Villages

Balasore District

Baliapal Block

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

- | | | |
|-----------------|---|----------|
| (i) Khagdapal | } | Villages |
| (ii) Basudeopur | | |

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

- | | | |
|------------------|---|----------|
| (i) Baliapal | } | Villages |
| (ii) Dalua | | |
| (iii) Kachuapada | | |

Koraput District

Jhorigaon Block

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

Bijapur — Village

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

Dabugaon block

Koilari — Village

Boipariguda block

- | | | |
|---------------|---|---------|
| (i) Talagaon | } | Village |
| (ii) Boliguda | | |

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

- | | | |
|-----------------|---|----------|
| (i) Chandrapada | } | Villages |
| (ii) Paliguda | | |

Nandpur block

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

- | | |
|-------------------|------------|
| (i) Proja Bhimdol | } Villages |
| (ii) Mali Bhimdol | |

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

- | | |
|-------------|------------|
| (i) Godiput | } Villages |
| (ii) Mulda | |
| (iii) Atub | |

Bondhugaon block

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

- | | |
|-------------------|------------|
| (i) Pedavellada | } Villages |
| (ii) Chinavellada | |

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTER

Yasada — Village

Besides the heads of sample households and donors, donees, land-owning non-donors and land-less labourers as stated in Tables 1-A and 1-B, 11 workers, 12 government officials and 17 office bearers (secretaries generally) of Gram-sabhas were interviewed. The workers and the Government officials worked in both successful and unsuccessful clusters. Though some of the office bearers belonged to successful and others to unsuccessful clusters, their responses were similar. Therefore, they have been clubbed together in this study. Thus the workers, the Government officials and the office bearers covered all the 10 clusters. At the time of interview it was found that the two *Sahukars* in the unsuccessful cluster I were not *Sahukars* in the sense they are supposed to operate. They were big agriculturists and did very little of moneylending business; their rate of interest was reasonable. The only two *Sahukars* in cluster IV of the successful group refused to give any information whatsoever.

Field work lasted from the second week of May to the second week of June, 1970. It was conducted in each cluster in two stages. First, a census was taken. Then the households were stratified in five categories mentioned earlier : (i) donors; (ii) donees; (iii) land-owning non-donors; (iv) land-less labourers; and (v) *sahukars*. After the selection of sample households on a random basis their heads were interviewed.

The following schedules were formulated :

(1) *General information Schedule* : To collect background information about the districts and blocks in which the selected clusters of villages were situated and about the villages themselves.

(2) *Donor's Schedule* : To collect information relating to the land donated, motivations for donation, joining of Gramdan, etc.

(3) *Donee's Schedule* : To collect information regarding the donees etc.

(4) *Land-owning Non-donor's schedule* : To collect information about the reasons of the respondents not donating land or joining the Bhoodan-Gramdan movement.

(5) *Schedule for landless labours* : To collect information regarding those who remained landless even after Bhoodan-Gramdan.

(6) *Schedule for Sahukars* : To gather information regarding the business of *Sahukars*, their mortgagees, their attitude towards Bhoodan-Gramdan.

(7) *Worker's Schedule* : To collect information about workers and their view of the movement.

(8) *Official's Schedule* : To gather informatoin

from block officials, Tehsildars and District Magistrates of the areas concerned.

Definitions :

Bhoodan—Gift of land by the landholders for re-distribution to the land-less agricultural families.

Gramdan :

(i) *Total* : When all the land-holders and non-holders of a village vest the ownership of all their land in Gram-sabha and where there is equitable re-distribution of land among the families in accordance with the number in each.

(ii) *Sulabh* : When 75 percent of the population join Gramdan and owners of 51 percent of the land of the village join it on the following terms and conditions:

(a) Giving away a minimum of one-twentieth of one's cultivable land for the land-less of the village.

(b) Vesting the ownership of all his land in the Gram-sabha of the village, the right over $19/20$ ths of this to remain unaffected subject to the condition that this land shall not be sold or mortgaged but can be transferred in full or in part to the Gram-sabha or to any family which has joined the Gram-sabha.

(c) Contributing to the Gram-kosh one-fourtieth (or any portion fixed by the Gram-sabha) of the produce of one's land calculated after deducting the land revenue. One having no land but making a living by other means to contribute one-thirtieth (or any portion fixed by the Gram-sabha) of his monthly incomes to the Gram-kosh either in cash or in labour.

The Gram-kosh was to be the community fund to be used for purposes of providing relief to the desti-

tutes and the orphans, creating educational facilities and establishing or renovating rural industries in the village.

One adult member from each family of the Gramdan village or all the adults of the village (as per decision of the Gram-sabha) would function either with unanimity or with consensus.

Donors : Persons living in the sample villages who have actually donated or have made declarations to donate land. Even if the piece of land later reverted to the donor he has been regarded as a donor for the purposes of this study.

Donees : Donees are those who have been allotted land donated by donors or those whose names appear in the list of those to whom land was to be allotted.

Land-owing Non-donors : Persons who have land under their possession but have not donated or made a declaration to donate any piece of their land.

Land-less Agricultural Labourers : Persons who have hardly any land of their own and work on other's land for a living.

Sahukars : Persons whose main business is money-lending generally at a very high rate of interest against mortgages of land with a view actually to getting possession of it.

Government officials : They were Block Development Officers, Tehsildars and District Magistrate of the areas in which the sample villages were situated.

Office Bearers of Gram-sabhas : The President and Secretary of Gram-sabha.

Workers : Persons who worked for getting Bhoodan and Gramdan and devoted their full time for it. ●

Socio-Economic Milieu

Introducing the District—Balasore and Koraput

Balasore, a northeastern district of Orissa, lies between $20^{\circ} 43' N$ and $21^{\circ} 59' N$ latitude and between $80^{\circ} 16' E$ and $87^{\circ} 29' E$ longitudes. Its boundaries extend in the north upto Midnapore district in West Bengal, in the south to Cuttack district, in the west to Keonjhar and Mayurbhanj and in the east to the Bay of Bengal. Koraput is the southern most district of Orissa and lies between $17^{\circ} 48' N$ and $20^{\circ} 7' N$ latitudes and between $81^{\circ} 24' E$ and $84^{\circ} 2' E$ longitudes. Its boundaries extend in the north to Raipur district of Madhya Pradesh, in the south to Vishakhapatnam and East Godavari districts of Andhra Pradesh, in the west to Bastar district of Madhya Pradesh and in the east to Srikakulam district of Andhra Pradesh and Ganjam district of Orissa.

Area

Balasore district which is the smallest of all the districts of Orissa covers an area of 2,507.0 square miles. Koraput is the largest district of the State and is almost four times as big as Balasore, covering an area of 9,91,000 square miles.¹

1. Census of India, 1961, Orissa.

(i) District Census Handbook Balasore, Superintendent of Census Operations, Orissa, Cuttack, 1967, p. 30.

Comparison with other Districts

Balasore district which has 4.17 percent of the State's area and 8.07 percent of the State's population is the 13th largest and the 6th most populous district of the State. The district of Koraput with 16.49 per cent of the State's area and 8.54 percent of State's population ranks first in area and fifth in population.¹

Density of Population

The total population of Balasore district in 1961 was 1,415,923. Koraput, although three times as large as Balasore,² had a total of 1,498,271 persons. The density of population in Balasore is 565 persons per square mile and in Koraput 151 persons per square mile as against the State average of 292 persons per square mile.³

Age-Groups

Children below 14 years of age constituted 38.7 percent and those in the working age group 15-59 years 55.0 percent of the total population of Balasore; 6.2 percent were above sixty years of age and 0.1 per cent unable to state their ages. In Koraput children below 14 years and those in the working age group 15-59 years constituted respectively 36.9 percent and 58.5 percent of the total population of the district, while

(ii) District Census Handbook Koraput, Vol. I. Superintendent of Census Operations, Orissa, Cuttack, 1965, p. 7.

1. (i) District Census Handbook Balasore, op. cit. p. 8.
- (ii) District Census Handbook Koraput, op. cit. p. 8-9
2. (i) District Census Handbook Balasore, op. cit. p.10.
- (ii) District Census Handbook Koraput, op. cit. p.10.
3. (i) District Census Handbook Balasore, op.cit. P.10.
- (ii) District Census Handbook Koraput, op.cit. p.10.

4.6 percent were above 60 years. Thus in Koraput those in the working age group had a higher percentage than in Balasore and those below 14 years and above 59 years a lower percentage.¹

Sex Ratio

There were 974 males for every 1,000 women in Balasore and 989 women for every 1,000 males in Koraput. The men-women ratio was thus lower in Balasore and higher in Koraput.

Castes

In Balasore the scheduled tribes and scheduled castes formed 6.8 percent and 18.8 per cent respectively of the total population, 74.4 per cent belonging to other castes. In Koraput the corresponding percentages were 60.90 and 12.40 respectively while other castes formed 26.70 percent. Thus there was predominance of other castes in Balasore and of scheduled tribes and castes in Koraput.

Literacy

The percentage of literacy worked out to 29.5 (comprising 23.2 males and 6.3 females) in Balasore district and 8.3 in Koraput district (with 6.8 males and 1.5 females) as against the State average of 17.3 percent among males and 4.3 percent among females.²

Density of Dwelling

Out of 246, 330 dwellings in the district of Balasore, 230,893 were in rural areas and 15,437 in towns.

1. (i) District Census Handbook Balasore op.cit p.14.
(ii) District Census Handbook Koraput, op.cit. p.14.
2. (i) District Census Handbook Balasore, op.cit. p.30.
(ii) District Census Handbook Koraput, op.cit. p.28.

In every 100 square miles of area in the district we would thus come across 9,822 dwellings. The density of dwellings per 100 square miles, for rural and urban areas of the district were 9,384 and 33,054 respectively. Koraput had a total of 306,913 dwelling houses, 292,060 and 14,853 in rural and urban areas respectively. This means a density of 3,094 dwelling houses per 100 square miles of area in the district as a whole and 2,954 and 47,913 dwelling houses in rural and urban areas respectively.

Materials of Walls and Roofs

The majority of village houses had mud walls. The next largest group of houses in rural areas had walls of grass, leaves, reeds or bamboo and only about 2.4 percent of houses had walls made of bricks, corrugated iron or metal sheets, cement, concrete, etc. In urban areas houses with brick walls formed the second largest groups.¹ A majority of houses in Balasore district had mud walls and thatched roofs. Walls of mud were found in 94.5 percent of houses in rural areas and in 79.8 percent of houses in urban areas. Only 1.0 percent of all the houses in rural areas and 8.3 percent of those in urban areas had brick walls.

Similarly, roofs made of corrugated iron, zinc or other metal sheets, asbestos sheets, bricks and lime on concrete were rarely seen in rural areas, but they could be found in nearly 16.7 percent of houses in towns. Thatching with grass, leaves, reeds, wood or bamboo covered a majority of houses in both rural and urban

1. (i) District Census Handbook Balasore, op.cit. p. 22-23
- (ii) District Census Handbook Koraput, op.cit. p. 22.

areas. Tiles, slate and shingle were also used but on a much smaller scale.

In Koraput roofs made of corrugated iron, zinc or other metal sheets, bricks and lime, concrete, asbestos sheets, etc. were rarely seen in rural areas but they were used in nearly 26 percent of houses in towns. Tiles, slate and shingle were used in about 3 percent of houses in rural areas and 9 percent of houses in the towns. But houses with thatched roofs or with roofs of grass, leaves, reeds, wood or bamboo formed the majority in towns as well as in villages, being about 66 percent and 96 percent of total houses in urban and rural areas respectively.

Number of Rooms and Number of Persons Per Room

Houses with three rooms and more formed 37.2 percent of the total number of houses in the district of Balasore. About 31.2 percent of the houses had one room each. The remaining had two rooms each. The number of persons inhabiting a room thus works out to 2.09 in rural areas and 2.37 in urban areas. Persons per room in the district and the State as a whole were 2.11 and 2.08 respectively.

In Koraput about 46 percent of houses had two rooms each. One roomed dwelling houses constituted nearly 43 percent of the total number of houses in the district. The rest had three rooms or more. The number of persons per room was generally 2.53 in the rural areas and 2.29 in urban areas. In the district as a whole the ratio is 2.51 persons to a room whereas in the State as a whole it is 2.08 persons to a room.

Land Tenure System

Tenants in Orissa had limited security of tenure and were liable to eviction in the exercise of the landlord's right to resume a limited area for personal cultivation, subject to the condition that a minimum area was left with the tenant. After the abolition of Zamindari tenants were brought into direct relation with the State and were given permanent and heritable rights.

Predominance of Agriculture

Majority of working population in both the districts were engaged in agricultural occupations. This shows that these districts like the State of Orissa and the country are underdeveloped.

The following table shows the land utilisation pattern of two districts and the State.¹

Table 2.

LAND UTILISATION PATTERN (PERCENTAGE)

	<i>Balasore District</i>	<i>Koraput District</i>	<i>Orissa State</i>
(i) Forests	5.96	12.3	23.1
(ii) Barren & Uncultivated land	2.99	19.2	9.9
(iii) Land put to non-agricultural uses	6.86	17.2	8.8
(iv) Cultivable waste	3.28	3.2	5.5
(v) Permanent pastures and Grazing land	3.62	2.7	4.0
(vi) Miscellaneous tree crops and groves	1.06	15.4	4.4
(vii) Current Fallow	3.09	0.7	3.8
(viii) Other fallow lands	1.06	0.1	1.3
(ix) Net area sown	67.06	27.3	38.2
(x) Non-reporting area	5.02	1.9	1.0

1. (i) Census Handbook, Balasore, p. 42
 (ii) Census Handbook, Koraput, Vol. I, p. 40

It can be seen from the above table that the percentage of net area shown was much higher than the State average in Balasore and lower than the State average in Koraput. Current fallow was much less in Koraput than in Balasore.

Cropping Pattern

Rice is the most prominent crop in both the districts of Balasore and Koraput as in the whole State of Orissa. The following table gives the cropping pattern (in terms of percentage) of the area cropped.¹

Table 3.

CROPS GROWN : PERCENTAGE OF AREA

	<i>Balasore District</i>	<i>Koraput District</i>	<i>Orissa State</i>
Gram (all varieties)	0.2	3.3	4.6
Groundnut	0.0	4.1	0.8
Maize	0.0	1.1	0.5
Mustard	0.0	10.1	1.5
Ragi	0.0	2.4	1.2
Rape	0.0	10.1	1.3
Rice	94.2	44.8	62.6
Sesamum	0.0	1.0	1.6
Sugarcane	0.1	0.9	0.4
Wheat	0.0	0.4	0.1
Others	5.5	21.8	25.4
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0

Groundnut, maize, mustard, ragi, rape, sesamum and wheat, which were grown in other parts of the State of Orissa, were reported to be not at all grown

1. (i) District Census Handbook Balasore, op.cit. p.42
- (ii) District Census Handbook Koraput, op. cit.p.41

in Balasore district. Gram, rice, sugarcane were grown but in areas less than the State average. In Koraput crops like gram, rice, sesamum the acreage was less than the State average, whereas that of groundnut, maize, mustard, ragi, rape, sugarcane and wheat was above the State average.

Castes in the Selected Clusters

In cluster I of both the successful and unsuccessful varieties the non-scheduled tribe households were predominant whereas in other clusters of the two types, except in cluster IV (successful), the scheduled tribes were in a majority. In cluster IV (successful) 50% were non-tribal and 50% tribal households. Although the sample households were not selected on the basis of castes and tribes, their caste composition was reflected in the samples (appendices : 3A to 7B).

Literacy of the Heads of the Households

1. Universe

In the successful variety 55.5 percent of the heads of households in cluster I, 3.4 percent in cluster II, 3.7 percent in cluster III, 38.3 percent in cluster IV and 3.2 in cluster V were literate. Corresponding percentages in unsuccessful clusters were 47.0% 9.2%, 0.9%, 0.9% and 0.9% respectively.

Socio-Economic Values :

In order to find out whether there was some kind of community feeling in the selected villages before Gramdan the sample donors were asked certain questions regarding (i) common village-land owned by the village community; (ii) existence of a common

fund for the village; (iii) the practice of following one village leader; and (iv) arrangements for looking after orphans, disabled persons, etc. of the village.

It was found that no cultivated land was owned by the village community collectively. Nor did a common fund exist in any of them. The practice of following a village leader, however, did prevail. The responses to questions regarding the looking after of orphans and disabled persons were mixed. Fourteen donors from four successful clusters (except cluster I) and three donors (two in cluster II and one in cluster III) of unsuccessful variety said that the village community provided food, clothing and shelter to the old and the orphans. But there was no organised scheme nor did all the households contribute to it. Such as it was, it was to be found only in tribal areas.

Land Ownership Pattern of Sample Households

(A) Donors

Most of the donors in successful cluster I owned 20 acres or more of land and in the unsuccessful cluster I owned 10 acres or less. Donors in other clusters of both the successful and the unsuccessful varieties owned 10 acres or less. Most land-owners, whether donors or non-donors, owned 10 acres or less. (Appendix 8)

(B) Donees

Donees in successful clusters had less than 10 acres of land before Bhoodan/Gramdan. Thirtyone of 44 such donees had 2.50 acres or less. In the unsuccessful clusters all the 26 landowning donees had five acres or less. (Appendix 8)

(C) Landowning Non-donors

Most of the landowning non-donors had land upto 10 acres. There were only 12 of them who owned more than 10 acres. (Appendix 8) This was so in both the types of clusters.

Donors and non-donors were to be found in all the categories of landholders. This shows that Bhoodan/Gramdan had response from all the sections rather than from only one segment of society.

(D) Landownership pattern of Sample Donors before Bhoodan-Gramdan (in acres)

It was found that most of the sample donors in successful clusters owned above five acres of land and in unsuccessful clusters more than two and a half acres. In the successful clusters one-thirds of the donors owned land between five and 10 acres. More than 50 per cent of the donors owned land between two and 2½ acres and 15 acres. This is borne out from the following table.

Table 4

LAND OWNERSHIP PATTERN OF SAMPLE DONORS
BEFORE BHOODAN-GRAMDAN (IN ACRES)

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
Successful clusters						
Not exceeding 2.5	—	—	1	1	—	2
Over 2.5-5.00	1	—	—	—	—	1
Over 5.00-10.00	1	2	4	2	1	10
Over 10.00-15.00	—	—	2	1	—	3
Over 15.00-20.00	—	—	2	1	2	5
Over 20.00-30.00	1	2	—	1	1	5
Over 30.00	2	1	—	—	1	4
Total	5	5	9	6	5	30

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

Not exceeding 2.5	2	-	-	1	-	3
Over 2.5-5.00	2	2	1	5	-	10
Over 5.00-10.00	-	4	1	2	1	8
Over 10.00-15.00	-	5	-	3	3	11
Over 15.00-20.00	-	1	1	-	2	4
Over 20.00-30.00	1	2	1	-	-	4
Over 30.0	-	1	1	1	-	3
Total	5	15	5	12	6	43

Only three sample donors in successful clusters owned five acres of land or less. Three sample donors owned not more than two and a half acres and three donors more than 30 acres.

(E) Land Ownership Pattern of Sample Donors after Bhoodan/Gramdan

It was found that the number of landowners in some groups had slightly increased and in others gone down to some extent as shown in the table below :

Table 5LAND OWNERSHIP PATTERN OF SAMPLE DONORS
AFTER BHOODAN/GRAMDAN (IN ACRES)

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Not exceeding 2.5	-	-	1	1	-	2
Over 2.5-5.0	1	-	1	-	1	3
Over 5.0-10.0	1	2	3	3	2	11
Over 10.0-15.0	-	-	4	1	-	5
Over 15.0-20.0	-	-	-	-	1	1
Over 20.0-30.0	2	2	-	1	1	6
Over 30.0	1	1	-	-	-	2
Total	5	5	9	6	5	30

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

Not exceeding 2.5	2	—	—	2	—	4
Over 2.5-5.0	2	2	1	4	—	9
Over 5.0-10.0	—	6	1	4	2	13
Over 10.0-15.0	—	4	—	1	4	9
Over 15.0-20.0	—	—	2	—	—	2
Over 20.0-30.0	1	2	—	1	—	4
Over 30.0	—	1	1	—	—	2
Total	5	15	5	12	6	43

The number of sample donors increased among groups owning 2.5-5.0, 5.0-10.0, 10.0-15.0 and 20.0-30.0 acres while among others it went down. In the unsuccessful clusters the sample donors increased in groups not owning more than 2.5 acres and also in the group which had 5.0-10.0 acres. It decreased in other groups. This is indicative of the impact of Bhoodan/Gramdan on landownership pattern of the donors.

(F) Landownership Pattern of Sample Donees.

The sample donees owned land less than five acres as shown below :

Table 6

LAND OWNED BY SAMPLE DONEES

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Not exceeding 2.5	3	1	1	1	—	6
2.50-5.0	—	2	1	—	—	3
Non-owners	4	2	3	6	7	22
Total	7	5	5	7	7	31
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Not exceeding 2.5	5	—	1	2	—	8
Non-owners	—	6	4	3	7	20
Total	5	6	5	5	7	28

In the successful clusters six donees owned upto 2.50 acres and three donees between 2.50 and 5.00 acres of land and in the unsuccessful clusters none of the land owning donees had land exceeding 2.5 acres. The rest of the donees were landless.

(G) *Lands Owned by Land-owning Sample Non-Donors.* Most of the sample non-donors owned upto 10 acres of land. The following table brings this out :

Table 7

LAND OWNED BY NON-DONOR SAMPLE HOUSEHOLDS
(ACRES)

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Not exceeding 2.5	3	3	2	4	9	21
Over 2.5 - 5.0	6	6	5	-	2	19
Over 5.0 - 10.0	3	3	1	1	-	7
Over 10.0 - 15.0	-	-	-	-	-	-
Over 15.0 - 20.0	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total	11	12	8	5	11	48
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Not exceeding 2.5	3	3	1	1	1	9
Over 2.5 - 5.0	-	5	5	3	7	20
Over 5.0 - 10.0	3	3	4	1	-	11
Over 10.0 - 15.0	-	1	-	-	1	2
Over 15.0 - 20.0	-	-	-	-	-	-
Over 20.0 - 30.0	-	-	2	-	-	2
Total	6	12	12	5	9	44

It will be seen here that only one non-donor in successful clusters and four non-donors in unsuccessful clusters owned more than 10.0 acres of land.

Summary

Koraput district was more than three times the area of that of Balasore. Balasore had a density of 565 persons per square mile and Koraput of 151 persons per square mile. The state average was 292 persons per square mile.

There was predominance of non-tribal population in Balasore district and of tribal in Koraput district.

The percentage of literacy was 29.5 in Balasore district and 8.3 in Koraput district.

The majority of houses in both the districts had mud walls and thatched roofs. The persons living per room are 2.11 in Balasore and 2.51 in Koraput districts, the state average being 2.08

After Zamindari Abolition the tenants of the state were brought into direct relation with the State and were given permanent and heritable rights.

Majority of working population in both districts are found to be engaged in agricultural occupation.

Rice is the most prominent crop in both the districts as in the State.

In Cluster I of both successful and unsuccessful variety non-tribal and in rest of the four clusters of the two types tribal population were in majority.

In the successful Cluster I, 55.5 per cent of the heads of households, 3.4 per cent of them in Cluster II, 3.7 per cent of them in Cluster III, 38.3 per cent in Cluster IV and 3.2 per cent in Cluster V were literate. Corresponding per centages in unsuccessful clusters were 47.0, 9.2, 0.9, 0.9 and 0.9 respectively.

No cultivated land was owned by the village community collectively before Gramdan. Neither Gramkosh existed. In Tribal villages Gramsabhas

were found earlier. Orphans, old and disabled persons were looked after by some sections of the tribal villages. Generally the villages followed one leader.

Bhoodan/Gramdan comprehended all sections of the village population. ●

Participation and Donation in Bhoodan/ Gramdan

Four types of respondent donors, donees, landless households and office bearers of Gramsabha — were asked whether they participated in Bhoodan/Gramdan movement. Their responses are tabulated below :

(i) *Donors' Participation in Bhoodan Movement.*

It was found that most of the donors in the successful clusters participated in the Bhoodan movement. This was not so in the unsuccessful ones :

Table 8

PARTICIPATION AND DONATION IN BHOODAN/ GRAMDAN						
	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Yes	4	—	—	—	—	4
No	1	—	—	—	—	1
Total	5	—	—	—	—	5
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Yes	1	—	—	—	—	1
No	3	—	—	—	—	3
Not applicable	1	—	—	—	—	1
Total	5	—	—	—	—	5

One of the villages of them was Gramdan and one respondent therefore said that Bhoodan did not apply to his village. Most of the donors in the unsuccessful cluster I did not participate in the Bhoodan Movement.

(ii) *Donors' Participation in Gramdan*

One can see from the following table that most of the sample donors participated in Gramdan movement.

Table 9

DONOR'S PARTICIPATION IN GRAMDAN

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Yes	—	3	8	6	4	21
No	3	—	1	—	1	5
Not applicable	1	—	—	—	—	1
Non-response	1	2	—	—	—	3
Total	5	5	9	6	5	30
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Yes	1	15	4	11	5	36
No	3	—	1	1	1	6
Not applicable	1	—	—	—	—	1
Total	5	15	5	12	6	43

In both the types of cluster I, successful and unsuccessful, participation by sample donors was lacking, obliterating, in this respect, the distinction between a successful and an unsuccessful cluster. In the rest of the clusters the proportion of participating households was quite high.

(iii) *Donees, Participation and their Method of Participation in Bhoodan*

Reasons for participation

Five donees in the successful cluster I stated that they understood that land was being collected from landholders for redistribution among the landless and the needy and that, therefore, if the movement was successful they might be benefitted. All the above five donees said that they participated in the movement with a view to getting some land. Two donees in the same cluster did so in the expectation of some benefit or the other.

As in the case of Bhoodan, so also in the case of Gramdan, the donees hoped to get land or some other benefit. Their responses are summarised in the following table :

Table 10

REASONS STATED BY DONEES FOR JOINING GRAMDAN						
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
1. To get land	—	2	4	4	5	15
2. To get some benefits to maintain his family	—	3	—	2	3	8
3. For village development	—	—	—	1	—	1
4. To get monetary help	—	—	1	1	3	5
5. No response	—	—	—	—	1	1

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
1. To get land	4	6	4	5	7	26
2. To get some benefit to maintain his family	5	—	1	—	—	6
3. For village develop- ment	—	—	1	—	—	1
4. To get monetary help	—	5	—	1	7	13

About 50 per cent of the sample donees said that they thought they would get land if Gramdan was successful in their villages. The donees in both the groups of clusters felt that land, in the absence of non-agricultural income, was the only means of securing livelihood. The second important reason in the successful group of clusters was expectation of benefits to help maintain one's family. In the unsuccessful clusters it was expectation of monetary help. Monetary help was emphasised mainly in unsuccessful cluster II and IV, but occupied the third place in the groups of successful clusters. Village-development hardly featured. The pattern of responses shows that individualism was still pre-dominant and donees did not think in terms of community life. The responses also indicate that the respondents thought in terms of redistribution of existing property and income rather than in terms of development.

Method of Participation in Bhoodan

It was found that only three of the seven donees in successful cluster I participated in Bhoodan. Two of these did so by joining Bhoodan workers in collection work and one by actively participating in the meeting of the Gramsabha organised for the purpose of land collection.

Method of Participation in Gramdan

A large number of donees in both the types of clusters, successful and unsuccessful, participated in the Gramdan movement. This can be seen from the following table :

Table 11**DONEES, PARTICIPATION IN GRAMDAN**

SUCCESSFUL	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
1. No. of households participated	—	5	5	7	7	24
2. Manner of participation :—						
(a) Joined workers and villagers in collection	—	3	2	7	6	18
(b) Participated in the meeting of Gramsabha	—	—	2	—	1	3
(c) No response	—	2	1	—	—	3
UNSUCCESSFUL						
1. No. of households participated	5	6	2	5	7	25
2. Manner of participation :—						
(a) Joined workers and villagers in collection.	1	1	—	—	5	7
(b) Participated in the meeting of Gramsabha	4	5	1	5	2	17
(c) No response	1	1	—	—	5	7

About three—fourths of donees in the successful clusters and—one fourth in the unsuccessful ones parti-

cipated by joining the workers and villagers in land collection. Three donees in the successful clusters and about 70 percent of the donees in the unsuccessful ones took part in the movement by associating themselves in the organisation of Gramsabha meetings and by taking part in its deliberations. There were some donees who with the passage of time had forgotten in what manner they participated in the movement.

(iv) Method of Participation of Landless Households in Bhoodan/Gramdan

It was one of the objectives of Gramdan that there should be no landless households in the village after Gramdan. Some households, however, in both the varieties of clusters, except in cluster V of successful variety, were found to be landless even after the distribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan had been completed. Gramdan redistribution was not to be static but a continuing process until near equality had been achieved. It may be that all the persons could not be covered in the first round of redistribution. In actual practice, however, redistribution once made remained frozen. The second phase of donation and redistribution of land was nowhere found. A majority of landless households were found to have participated in Bhoodan/Gramdan movement. Their number and manner of participation is summarised in the table below :

Table 12

PARTICIPATION OF LANDLESS SAMPLE HOUSEHOLDS
IN BHOODAN/GRAMDAN

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
(a) No. of households who participated	1	7	2	3	—	13

(b) Manner of participation :

(i) Persuaded villagers to donate land

1 — — 1 — 2

(ii) Attended meeting of Gramsabha

— 1 1 2 — 4

(c) No. of households who did not participate.

4 1 3 2 — 10

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

(a) No. of households who participated

C1 C2 C3 C4 C5 TOTAL

4 3 3 2 4 16

(b) Manner of participation :

(i) Persuaded villagers to donate land

— — — — 1 1

(ii) Attended meeting of Gramsabha

3 3 2 — 3 11

(iii) Co-operated with village people

1 — 1 2 — 4

(c) No. of households who did not participate

3 2 2 3 1 11

It will be observed that landless households participated in the movement in one of the following ways:

(i) persuading villagers to donate land.

(ii) co-operating with the village people.

(iii) attending meeting of Gramsabha.

The most important method of participation in the successful clusters was cooperation with the village people. In the unsuccessful ones it was attending meetings of Gramsabha. The second most important in the successful clusters was attending meetings of Gramsabha and in the unsuccessful ones co-operation with the village people. Persuading the people for Bhoodan/Gramdan as a manner of participation was mentioned by an insignificant number of landless households. It seems they were conscious that since they were landless they did not carry weight with other villagers. However, other more modest methods of participation by landless households were no less useful to the movement.

There were, however, many landless households who for one reason or other did not participate in the Bhoodan/Gramdan movement (see appendix 9). It was found that an almost equal number of landless workers' households in both the types of clusters did not participate in the Bhoodan/Gramdan movement. Three respondents in the successful clusters and five in the unsuccessful ones could not participate because they migrated to the village after Gramdan. The pattern of responses shows that in all the sample villages the movement was quite comprehensive. Even landless households, which could not donate land but were likely to be just beneficiaries, were not left out of the movement.

(v) Participation in Bhoodan/Gramdan by Office Bearers of the Gramsabha

No Gramsabha was formed in cluster I whether of the successful or of the unsuccessful variety. This

made a world of difference between *adivasi* and non-*adivasi* areas. All the office bearers of Gramsabha in the other clusters participated in the Gramdan Prapti work. They did so by helping the workers in organising meetings of the village people to explain the principles and benefits of the movement. They also accompanied the Bhoodan/Gramdan workers to the village in their mission to persuade people in an informal manner. Most of the office bearers also contributed to the movement by canvassing in groups and individual basis for Gramdan Prapti.

(vi) *Proportion of land Donated.*

The donors in both the types of clusters were asked if they knew that in Bhoodan one-sixths and one-twentieths of their land was expected to be donated by them for redistribution to the needy. Although none of them were aware of this, a large number had actually donated more than the minimum, as the following table shows :

Table 13
PROPORTION OF LAND DONATED

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
Proportion of land donated upto 5%	2	—	—	—	—	—
More than 5 — 10%	1	—	1	—	—	3
" " 10 — 20%	—	—	1	1	—	3
" " 20 — 40%	—	2	5	5	1	13
" " 40 — 60%	—	3	2	—	1	6
" " 60 — 80%	1*	—	—	—	3	3
" " 80 — 100%	1	—	—	—	—	1
Total	5	5	9	6	5	30

* Not actually parted

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

Proportion of land
donated

upto 5%	—	—	3	4	—	7
More than 5—10%	—	4	—	4	3	11
„ „ 10—20%	—	7	1	4	3	15
„ „ 20—40%	—	4	1	—	—	5
„ „ 40—60%	—	—	—	—	—	—
„ „ 60—80%	—	—	—	—	—	—
„ „ 80—100% 5*	—	—	—	—	—	5
Total	5	15	5	12	6	43

There was a high incidence of donors around 10—40% in successful clusters and around 5-20% in the unsuccessful one.

Sections of the Village Community which donated land :

It would be useful to know which sections of farmers donated land for Bhoodan/Gramdan. For this purpose they were divided into three groups : (i) rich farmers, (ii) middle farmers and (iii) poor farmers. On the basis of worker's responses it was found that more or less all the sections of the farmers donated land.

Donor's Reason for Donating Land.

The donors were asked to state whether they had donated land under coercion—of the Bhoodan/Gramdan workers or of the village elite—or did so voluntarily. Here 'voluntary' did not rule out persuasion or explanation of the aims and objectives of Bhoodan/Gramdan, but it ruled out any pressure whatsoever. In case of donation under pressure they were asked to

* Not actually parted

give their replies under two heads : (i) in their own case and (ii) in the case of others.

All the donors except one said that they donated land voluntarily and not under pressure of the workers or of the village elite. Only one donor in successful cluster II said that a person (not himself) donated land owing to the coercion of workers (see Appendices 10,12 A & 11 B). In this case the worker was said not to have used any threat but to have approached the donor many times.

It is interesting to note that all the Bhoodan donors, with only one exception, and all the Gramdan donors of land donated part of their land without any fear of forcible occupation or of legislation (see Appendices 10,11 A & 11 B).

Landowning Non-donors' Reason for not Donating Land.

Several reasons were stated by landowning non-donors for not donating any land in Bhoodan or Gramdan. They are tabulated below :

Table 14

REASONS FOR NOT DONATING ANY LAND						
Reasons	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTER						
1. Insufficient land	7	10	7	4	9	37
2. Gramsabha decided that people with little land need not part with it	-	-	-	-	2	2

3. Respondent unwilling to part with land	—	1	—	1	—	2
4. Large size of the household	2	—	—	—	—	2
5. Land not fertile	1	—	—	—	—	1
6. Respondent minor at the time of movement	1	—	—	—	—	1
7. Respondent migrated to the village after donation	1	1	1	—	—	3
Total	12	12	8	5	11	48

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

1. Insufficient land	4	9	10	5	5	33
2. Gramsabha decided that people with little land need not part with it	—	—	—	—	4	4
3. Respondent unwilling to part with land	1	3	1	—	—	5
4. Respondent minor at the time of donation	1	—	1	—	—	2
Total	6	12	12	5	9	44

Insufficiency was most commonly a reason for not donating land. Other reasons were not significant.

Officebearers of Gramsabhas

Office bearers of Gramsabhas held that the main reasons for donation of land were : (i) helping the

poor and landless to enable them to cultivate donated land and to live upon it; (ii) improvement of the village; (iii) helping the community way of life; and (iv) obtaining benefits after donation for improvement of the rest of the land.

According to them, the main reason why some landowners did not donate land was that they were not approached. Some others believed that they did not want to participate in the movement because they did not understand the significance of the movement.

It was, however, found that only two landowning non-donor respondents in the successful and four in the unsuccessful clusters relied on the decision of the Gramsabha for not making a donation of land. Thus the responses of the office bearers of Gramsabha and of landowning non-donors were not in conformity with each other.

To Whom Land was Donated

Most of the donors said that they had donated land to the Gramsabha. Only one donor in each group of clusters had donated to specific persons.

Occasion of Donating Land

There were generally two occasions on which declarations of donation were made—one was when meetings were addressed by Bhoodan/Gramdan leaders and the other when persuasion was tried in personal approaches by Bhoodan/Gramdan workers and/or the village elite.

It was found that most of the donors donated land at the time of the meeting of leaders of the movement.

Spade work was done and the ground was psychologically prepared by the workers before meetings were

held. Generally the decision to declare the donations at the time of the meeting was taken prior to the meeting.

Personal approach to landowners continued even after the meetings and some did respond. One donor from successful cluster I, seven from the unsuccessful group of clusters, (two from cluster I, one each from clusters II and III and three from cluster IV) stated that it was thus that they had made their donations. Two landowners in the successful clusters and one in the unsuccessful ones were unable to say anything in this regard. The rest of the donors, 27 in the successful clusters and 35 in the unsuccessful ones did not respond to approaches after the meeting.

The only donor in the successful cluster who donated land when approached by workers did so because the Zamindari system was being abolished in Orissa and in consequence he was going to lose some of his land any way. He thought he would rather take credit by donating land rather than be deprived by losing it in the course of Zamindari abolition. Seven in the unsuccessful clusters made their donation later either because they had not made any at the time of the meeting or subsequently felt like donating some more land.

Official Help and Obstacles

If development work had been done in Bhoodani/Gramdani village it might have had a demonstration effect on other villages which could be induced to opt for Bhoodan/Gramdan more easily. Government help would have undoubtedly given a fillip to such works.

The office-bearers of Gramsabhas were, therefore, asked to express their view of the attitude of Government officials towards the development of Bhoodani/Gramdani villages.

Most of the office-bearers felt that Government/officials were neither helpful nor obstructive but just indifferent to development work. Three stated that officer at the block level helped by supplying the cultivators with seeds and fertilisers and by constructing a school building and a building for Graingola.* Four office-bearers of Gramsabhas said that officials hindered village development by helping the Sahukars. In their opinion police and forest officials conspicuously mixed with the Sahukars to make the village people feel threatened and insecure. They reportedly threatened the Gramdani villagers that they would file suits against them in the courts. Government officials also spread a rumour that Gramdan workers were not interested in redistributing land and because of this some of the donors took back the land donated by them.

Summary

Five types of respondents donors, donees, landless households, office-bearers of the Gramsabha and workers, participated in the Bhoodan/Gramdan movement.

These respondents participated mostly by joining the work leading to declaration and/or parting with land for Bhoodan/Gramdan such as persuasion, organising meetings of Gramsabhas and attending the meetings of Gramsabhas. The officials of the Gramsabhas

* Graingola is a place where grain is stored for loaning in kind to the needy villagers.

helped the workers also by introducing them to the villagers.

The donees, and mostly landless and officials of Gramsabhas, participated in the movement with a view to getting some land/or for improving their material conditions. Hardly any donee thought of the welfare of others in the village. Thus the donees and landless households participated mostly for their own sake. Generally when one has not even proper and secure means of livelihood, it is quite natural to think only for the self.

There were some heads of landless households which did not participate in the movement for one or the other of the following reasons : (i) no idea about the movement, (ii) no idea about the utility of the movement, (iii) migrated into the village after Gramdan (iv) not present in the village at the time of Gramdan, and (v) nobody approached.

Generally it was found that in all the sample villages the movement was quite comprehensive. Even the landless households which would not donate land but were likely to be only beneficiaries were not left out of the movement.

Though none of the sample donors were aware that one-sixth of their land had to be donated in Bhoodan and one-twentieth in Gramdan for redistribution to the landless and the needy a large number of them had actually donated more than the minimum.

The donors donated their land voluntarily. They gave several reasons for donating the land such as (i) persuasion of Bhoodan/Gramdan workers, (ii) convinced with the ideology of the movement (iii) impressed by saint like Vinoba, (iv) because others

were donating, (v) wanted to give land to the landless, (vi) to help village development, (vii) the landless must have feeling of village attachment, (viii) for integrated development of the whole village, (ix) to abolish exploitation, (x) Gramsabha to plan for village development, (xi) Gramsabha would collect resources for the village, (xii) developing a feeling of co-operation, unity and belongingness, (xiii) for community life in the village, (xiv) afraid of forcible occupation of land and (xv) fear of land legislations. All the Bhoodan Gramdan donor with the solitary exception of a Bhoodan donor donated land voluntarily.

The main reason why some of the land owners did not donate land was that they were not approached, others did not donate as they did not understand the significance of the movement. The land was generally donated to the ad-hoc Gramsabha at the time of the meeting organised for this purpose.

The Government officials were generally indifferent to Bhoodan/Gramdan. Some officials were hostile and hindered the work. Very few of them helped by supplying seeds and fertilisers, construction of school building and Graingola.

Distribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan Land

1. *Procedures of Distribution*

It was to be expected that the agency which redistributed land would follow some regular procedure. Three sets of respondents (i) office-bearers of Gramsabha, (ii) workers and (iii) Government officials were asked if there were some determinants of distribution of land donated in Bhoodan/Gramdan.

Office-bearers of Gramsabhas

The office-bearers of Gramsabhas knew of the following two principles : (i) distribution through the machinery of Gramsabha, and (ii) allotment first to the landless and then to those who had very little land of their own. Two office-bearers added another - the size of households; larger households getting more land than the smaller ones.

2. *Conditions to be Fulfilled by the Donees*

Workers : Bhoodan/Gramdan workers were asked what conditions if any were attached to allotment of Bhoodan/Gramdan land to donees. Their responses are summarised below.

Conditions to be fulfilled
by donees

No. of workers
who mentioned
the conditions

(1) No mortgage of
allotted land

9

(2)	No sale of allotted land	9
(3)	Cultivation by donees	3
(4)	Land not to remain unutilised	2
(5)	No share cropping on donated land	1
(6)	Loan if any on mortgage of Bhoo-dan/Gramdan land to be taken from cooperative or government.	1

Landholders who joined Gramdan were also expected to observe the above conditions. Mortgages and sales in the Gramdani villages were expected to be executed with the approval of Gramsabha.

3. *Process of Distribution.*

i. **Bhoo-dan Land**

In the successful cluster I where both Bhoo-dan and Gramdan work was said to have been done two sample donors said that Bhoo-dan land was distributed through the machinery of ad-hoc Gramsabha. One of the donors expressed his inability to say anything. Remaining two donors did not respond to the question. All the sample donors in the unsuccessful clusters stated that since land was not distributed in their villages, the question was of no relevance to them.

ii. **Gramdan Land**

It was found that in cluster I of both the varieties,

no *pushti* work had been done and no distribution had been undertaken even after the declaration of Gramdan. This again was a distinguishing feature between non-*adivasi* and *adivasi* clusters. All the donors in the rest of the clusters, except one in the unsuccessful cluster II, stated that donated land was allotted to the donees by the Gramsabhas. Only one donor said that donees received land at the suggestion of the donors.

iii. Process of Distribution of Bhoodan Land as Known to the Donees

The Bhoodan donees in the successful cluster I gave four sets of responses in this regard. Two donees stated that the decision for distribution of Bhoodan land was taken at the combined meeting of Bhoodan Samiti and the villagers. According to other two donees no uniform procedure for distribution was adopted. Three donees were unable to say anything.

iv. Process of Distribution of Gramdan as Known to the Donees

Quite a large number of donees in both the types of clusters showed their awareness of the process of redistribution of Gramdan land.

Nearly 90 per cent of the donees in the successful clusters and about 69 percent of the min the unsuccessful ones stated that Gramdan land was redistributed through the agency of Gramsabha. Only a few mentioned other processes of redistribution. Since land was redistributed through the machinery of Gramsabha, there was a high degree of uniformity in the responses.

4. *Awareness Regarding the Proportion of Donated land Distributed :*

i. DONORS

(a) Bhoodan

In the successful cluster I only one sample donor knew that all the land donated in Bhoodan was redistributed. Three expressed their inability to say anything in this regard. One of the donors did not make any response to the inquiry regarding the proportion of Bhoodan land distributed. All the five donors in the unsuccessful clusters had definite knowledge that no land redistribution had taken place in their villages.

(b) Gramdan

Donors were asked to state what proportion of land obtained in Gramdan had been redistributed. All donors in the successful clusters were aware that the entire land donated for Gramdan was redistributed. The same response was had from quite a large number of donors in the unsuccessful clusters. According to seven of the latter, five from cluster I and two from cluster III, no redistribution had taken place. Here, again the distinction between non-*adivasi* and *adivasi* areas is evident. Two donors, one from Cluster II and one from Cluster III, said that 50 per cent, of donated land had been redistributed. Two donors, one in Cluster IV and one in Cluster V, were unaware of the distribution aspect of Gramdan.

ii. DONEES

(a) Bhoodan

In the successful Cluster I according to one donee all donated land, and according to another less than

25% had been redistributed. Two did not know what proportion of donated land had been redistributed. Three donees were not aware of any redistribution at all, for, although declared donees, they had not actually received any land.

(b) Gramdan

A very high proportion of Gramdan donees were aware of redistribution of Gramdan land as the following table shows :

Table 15

AWARENESS OF DISTRIBUTION OF LAND AND OF
PROPORTION OF LAND REDISTRIBUTED

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
No. of donees who said distribution had been made		4	5	7	7	23
Percentage of land dis- tributed :						
(i) All donated land		4	5	7	7	23
No. of donees who had no knowledge of redistribution		1	—	—	—	1
No. of donees who said distribution has been made		6	3	5	6	20
Percentage of land distributed						
(i) All donated land		6	1	—	—	7
(ii) Not known			2	5	6	13
No response		—	2	—	1	3
Not distributed		5	—	—	—	5

About 75 per cent of the donees in the successful clusters and about 75 per cent in the unsuccessful ones were aware of distribution of all donated land. About 50 per cent in the unsuccessful clusters did not know the proportion in which land had been distributed.

To Whom the Land was Redistributed.

An attempt was made to find out from different categories of respondents as to who were the beneficiaries of Bhoodan and Gramdan.

In the successful cluster I four of the five donors were of the opinion that Bhoodan land had been allotted to the landless and the needy. The fifth was very categorical in saying that it was donated to the close relatives of Bhoodan workers. None of the donees, however, claimed to be related to these workers. In the unsuccessful cluster the question did not arise as land was not redistributed.

Table 16

PERSONS TO WHOM GRAMDAN LAND WAS ALLOTTED.

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) Landless	—	3	8	6	5	22
(ii) Close relations of donors	—	2	1	—	—	3
(iii) Members of donor's family	—	—	—	—	—	—
Total	—	5	9	6	5	25
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) Landless	—	6	3	11	6	26
(ii) Close relations of donors	—	9	—	1	—	10
(iii) Members of donor's family	—	—	1	—	—	1
NOT DISTRIBUTED	5	—	1	—	—	6
Total	5	15	5	12	6	43

The incidence of donation to close relations of donors was low in the successful clusters and a little less than 25 per cent in the unsuccessful clusters. In *adivasi* areas the social organisation is such that villagers are more often than not related to one another; it is possible that the donor and donee happened to be related. The donors said that land had been redistributed through the agency of the Gramsabha and that they did not influence redistribution in any manner.

Three beneficiaries had definite opinions as to whom the Bhoodan land was allotted. One of them said that it was given to the close relations of donors, another that it went to the relations of Bhoodan workers and the third said that it was allotted to the landless. Corroboration by other types of respondents was lacking. Two of the donees were unable to say anything. They responded like this as they had not actually received any land in Bhoodan/Gramdan. Their names were listed, as donees for allotting land.

Table 17

DONEES' OPINION OF THE TYPE OF PERSONS TO WHOM LAND WAS ALLOTTED

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) To landless	—	—	5*	7	7	19
(ii) Close relation of donors	—	4	1	—	—	5
(iii) Unable to state	—	1	—	—	—	1
Total	—	5	7	7	7	25

*One and the same donee stated that land was donated in some cases to landless and in some other cases to close relations of donors.

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

(i) To landless	—	6	3	5	7	21
(ii) Unable to state	—	—	2	—	—	2
(iii) Land not distributed	5	—	—	—	—	5
Total	5	6	5	5	7	28

Around 16 per cent of the donees in successful clusters, mostly from cluster II, said that land was donated to the close relations of donor. Thus the donor's opinion was to some extent corroborated by donees in cluster II.

Office-bearers of Gramsabhas, however, categorically stated that no donated land was allotted to any family member of donors. Thirteen of them said that it was not allotted even to close relations of donors and four who admitted that this had happened in some cases added that the donees in these cases were landless and the decision in each case had been taken by the Gramsabha concerned.

Most of the Government officials at different levels showed their ignorance in this regard. They had simply no idea of what type of persons had benefitted from redistribution of Bhoodan Gramdan land; one of the Tehsildars first said he did not know but later stated the Bhoodan land had been distributed to members of the donor's family or to close relations. Of the two District Magistrates, one was of the view that Bhoodan land was allotted to the poor and the needy whereas the other District Magistrate said he had information, not hearsay information either, that generally under cover of Gramdan movement land was distributed among members of the same family to avoid registration fees.

B. Land Allotted to Gramsabha

An effort was to be made to retain some land for common cultivation provided so much land was donated that all the landless agricultural labourers were allotted some land. A portion of the donated land, it was expected, would be set aside for common cultivation by voluntary labour. Land revenue and welfare activities of the village were to be paid for from the produce of this land. The fact that only in cluster V of the successful type a piece of 4.20 acres was retained by the Gramsabha for common cultivation goes to show that the objective of community land and common cultivation was not realised in a majority of cases. The probable reasons were (i) not enough land was donated and many households remained landless, and (ii) the villagers had not developed community feeling. The result was the land revenue continued to be paid individually and no welfare activity could be undertaken.

6. Whether the Land was Redistributed to the Needy

It was expected that after knowing the experiences of donation of land and its redistribution some of the respondents would give a more balanced opinion regarding the inquiry whether the land was redistributed to the needy or not. Inquiries were made from the donors, donees and land owning non-donors to find out if they felt that land obtained in donations was given to those who really needed it.

Most of the donors were found to be of the view that land was distributed to the needy. Nine donors

of the unsuccessful clusters who had earlier stated that land was allotted to close relations of donors also thought that such donees were needy.

As for the beneficiaries, over three-fourths of them in each set of clusters felt that Bhoodan/Gramdan land was allotted to the needy. The few donees who thought otherwise were from successful cluster I.

The responses of the land owning non-donors were important in as much as they would indicate whether they had refrained from donating because they feared it would not go to the really needy. Most of them were of the view that land was redistributed to the landless who were naturally needy. Some of the non-donors, because of failure of communication or because of their indifference, were unaware of any land redistribution in their villages.

7. Difficulties Faced in Distribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan Land

The workers and government officials were considered appropriate persons for making inquiries regarding distribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan land. The responses of workers and government officials are dealt with in the chapter 'Role of Workers.'

8. Incidence of Land Revenue of Bhoodan Land Distributed in the Course of Bhoodan/Gramdan.

It was expected that since in a Gramdani village land was vested in the Gramsabha, land revenue and land cess would be paid by the Gramsabha and that no one, whether donor or donee or any other kind of landowner, would be required to pay these individually. The Government of Orissa stopped collecting

land revenue in 1967 when the Jan Congress-Swatantra party coalition came to power, although land cess continued to be levied on land owners.

Inquiries were made from donors and donees regarding the payment of land revenue (before 1967) and land cess on land settled with the donees.

1. Donors

The donors gave three sets of responses. They are as follows —

Table 18

PAYMENT OF LAND REVENUE OF THE LAND ALLOTTED TO THE DONEES

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) By donor	—	—	4	2	1	7
(ii) By donees	1	—	—	—	—	1
(iii) By donee through donor	4	5	5	4	4	22
Total	5	5	9	6	5	30
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) By donor	5	7	2	6	6	26
(ii) By donee through donor	—	8	3	6	—	17
Total	5	15	5	12	6	43

Less than 25 per cent of the donors in successful clusters and about 60 percent in the unsuccessful ones said that since the liability vested with them they were paying land revenue and land cess. The only exception, according to them was a donee who himself paid both the levies. About two-thirds of the households in successful clusters and a little over one-thirds in the unsu-

successful ones were said to be paying land revenue and land cess through donors as the title deeds were still in the latter's names.

In the case of Bhoodan land two donees in the successful cluster I stated that they paid land revenue and cess through the donors concerned. Two did not know if any taxes were payable, nor who paid them. Three donees were definite that no taxes were being paid at all by anybody. Possibly the land of which they spoke was uncultivable waste or under water of the river Subarnarekha.

In the case of Gramdan land it was found that in some cases the donors themselves and in others the donees through the donors paid these charges. The replies of respondents in this connection are tabulated below :—

Table 19

PAYMENT OF LAND REVENUE ON LAND ALLOTTED TO DONEES						
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
(i) By donor	—	1	3	1	—	5
(ii) By donee through donor	—	4	2	6	7	19
Total	—	5	5	7	7	24
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) By donor	—	—	4	3	7	14
(ii) By donee through donor	—	6	—	2	—	8
(iii) Not known	—	—	1	—	—	1
(iv) Land not distributed	5	—	—	—	—	5
Total	5	6	5	5	7	28

Land Revenue Paid by Individuals and not by Gramsabha

It was found that land revenue and cess were paid by the persons who held the legal titles and not by the village community. No donee paid either of the two taxes directly to the state.

One of the conditions of Gramdan, it will be recalled, was that the ownership of land would pass to the Gramsabha which would pay taxes for the whole village. This condition was not fulfilled. Gramdan had failed to inculcate the community feeling it aimed at. Individual ownership of land continued even after Gramdan.

9. *Registration and Mutation of Land*

Registration and mutation of allotted land was necessary to enable the donee, whether an individual or a collective entity, to feel a sense of security. This was even more so in a situation in which land revenue and land cess were paid by donees individually mostly through donors. But as a rule this was not done. Only one Bhoodan donor said, and the donee confirmed, that registration and mutation of Bhoodan land was made in the donee's name.

10. *Reversion of Bhoodan/Gramdan Land from the Donees to the Donors.*

In the absence of legal transfer of donated land and its registration in the name of donees it was to be feared that land would revert to the donors. In the course of inquiry it was found that this had actually happened. Cases of reversion as mentioned by donees are given below :—

Table 20

DONEES' AWARENESS OF REVERSION OF DONATED
LAND : GRAMDAN

	CI	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
No. of donees having knowledge	-	4	3	3	-	10
No. of donees having no knowledge	7	1	2	4	7	21
Total	7	5	5	7	7	31
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
No. of donees having knowledge	2	2	4	3	-	11
No. of donees having no knowledge	3	4	1	2	7	17
Total	5	6	5	5	7	28

Roughly one-third of the donees in both the types of clusters knew that there were cases of reversion of donated land from the donees to the donors. If there was legal provision for transfer of titles reversion could have been prevented.

Causes of reversion were (i) non-utilisation of donated land owing to lack of resources; (ii) death of the donee without heir (iii) migration of the donee from the village, and (iv) refusal of the donee to cultivate the donated land.

Two things about reversion are significant. One is that land reverted to the donor and not to the Gramsabha. This shows that the sense of individual ownership persisted even in Gramdani villages. The other

is that if the legal ownership had been transferred, the original owners could not have got back the land. This shows the importance of law for Bhoodan/Gramdan redistribution of land. It was creditable that a large number of *Adivasi* donors stood by their donations. This speaks of the high integrity and honesty of the *Adivasi*.

11. Necessity of Land Redistribution

The non-donors' response in this regard is noted below:—

Table 21

I. VIEWS OF NONDONORS REGARDING LAND REDISTRIBUTION AS A NECESSARY MEASURE

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) No. of heads who regard as necessary	11	10	8	3	6	38
(ii) No. of heads who regard as unnecessary	1	—	—	—	—	1
(iii) No. of heads who were unable to express their opinion	—	2	—	2	5	9
Total	12	12	8	5	11	48

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

(i) No. of heads who regard as necessary	6	12	8	4	1	31
--	---	----	---	---	---	----

(ii) No. of heads who regard as unnecessary

— — — — —

(iii) No. of heads who were unable to express their opinion

	—	—	4	1	8	13
Total	6	12	12	5	9	44

Most of the land owning non-donors, despite the fact that they themselves did not donate land in Bhoodan/Gramdan, expressed themselves in favour of land redistribution. These heads of non-donating households who had no opinion to give apart, only one non-donor was against redistribution of land. The reasons he gave for this view were : (a) donees do not properly utilize the land, (b) donees sell the donated land to third persons, (c) Gramsabha is inefficient and (d) Bhoodan workers are corrupt.

ii. Government Officials

Most of the Government officials were in favour of land redistribution. Only two (one a B. D. O. and the other a Tehsildar) were opposed to it.

12. Methods of Redistribution Preferred

Bhoodan/Gramdan land collection and distribution work had taken place quite some time ago. Donors, donees, landowning non-donors and officials could be expected to be in a better position, on the basis of their experience of these movements, to express their preference for some particular method of land collection and redistribution. Inquiries were made from them to ascertain their preferences.

Donors

One donor in cluster I was in favour of legislation. Two donors in the unsuccessful clusters spoke of legislation not as a substitute of but as a supplement to Bhoodan/Gramdan method to make possible the transfer of title to land from the donor to the donee. The rest preferred Bhoodan/Gramdan method of land collection and distribution.

Donees

In successful Cluster I two donees were of the opinion that land should be collected and redistributed through the machinery of law. The rest of the donees in the successful clusters and all in the unsuccessful ones were in favour of Bhoodan/Gramdan method of land redistribution. No one expressed a preference for Naxalite methods.

Table 22

METHOD OF LAND COLLECTION/DISTRIBUTION FAVOURED BY NON-DONORS

	CI	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
METHODS FAVOURED						
(i) Bhoodan/Gramdan	2	7	2	—	4	15
(ii) Legislation	7	—	—	—	—	6
(iii) Peaceful method	—	1	2	3	—	7
(iv) Unable to suggest	3	4	4	2	7	20
Total	12	12	8	5	11	48
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) Bhoodan/Gramdan	2	12	1	—	—	15

(ii) Legislation	3	—	—	—	—	3
(iii) Peaceful method	—	—	4	3	1	8
(iv) Unable to suggest	1	—	7	2	8	18
Total	6	12	12	5	9	44

It was found that a large number of non-donors were unable to suggest any particular method. Of those who did most were for Bhoodan/Gramdan and peaceful methods. Only in cluster I of both the varieties did landowning non-donors express a preference for legislation for this purpose.

v. Government Officials

All the officials favoured legislation as a means of land collection and redistribution. They felt that surplus land in excess of the ceiling (which should not be less than the economic holdings) should be mopped up by the State and allotted to the needy. Two officials added that law should supplement Bhoodan Gramdan. One official said that after the abolition of Zamindari there was no chance of getting land through Bhoodan/Gramdan. Land should be obtained only through legislative measures and then distributed.

None of the four types of respondents—donors, donees, non-donors and government officials favoured Naxalite methods for redistribution of land.

Reasons of Landless Still Being There

It was one of the objectives of Gramdan that no household should be without land. A large number of households, however, were landless after Gramdan. Some of the landless respondents from both the types of clusters were requested to give reasons for their still being landless. Their responses are given in the following table.

Table 23

REASONS FOR BEING LANDLESS

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

REASONS :	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Table:
i. No money to purchase land	4	5	1	1	—	11
ii. Did not receive any land	—	—	—	1	—	1
iii. Respondents migrated to village after distribution	—	3	4	1	—	8
iv. No surplus land left after distribution	—	—	—	1	—	1
v. Respondents were out of village at the time of distribution	—	—	—	1	—	1
Total	4	8	5	5	—	22

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

i. No money to purchase land	4	—	6	2	—	12
ii. Land not yet redistributed in the village	1	—	—	—	—	1
iii. Did not receive any land	2	—	—	—	—	2
iv. Respondents migrated to the village after distribution	—	5	—	3	2	10

v. No surplus land
left over after
distribution

	—	—	—	—	3	3
Total	7	5	6	5	5	28

It is apparent that the most important reason for landlessness in the view of the respondents was lack of money to purchase land. The second most important reason given was that these households had migrated to the village after land redistribution had been completed. Other reasons were of minor importance.

Summary

There were some general procedures for the redistribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan land. The office-bearers of the Gramsabha were aware of some of them.

Generally the land was redistributed to the needy landless agricultural labourers, households and to those with little land through the machinery of ad-hoc Gramsabha. Most of the donors and donees knew this procedure.

In Cluster I of both the varieties very little land was actually redistributed. There only a list of donors and donees was prepared.

The donees had to fulfil certain conditions for getting land allotted to them such as (i) they would not sell or mortgage the allotted land; (ii) they would cultivate the land themselves; (iii) land would not remain unutilised; (iv) loan on mortgage of such land to be borrowed from co-operative or Government. However, most of these conditions were expected to be fulfilled by all the landholders of the Gramdani villager.

There was difference of opinion regarding the proportion of Bhoodan/Gramdan land redistributed. Some respondents said that all donated land was redistributed. Others stated that 50 percent of Bhoodan/Gramdan land was redistributed. A few were of the view that only 25 percent of donated land was redistributed. There were some respondents who did not know what proportion of such land was actually redistributed.

Most of the government officials at different levels showed their ignorance regarding the kind of persons who were beneficiaries of Bhoodan/Gramdan land.

Hardly any Gramdan land was retained in any village for common cultivation as the land hunger could not be satisfied and some agricultural households were still landless after Bhoodan/Gramdan.

The Gramsabha was not paying land revenue or other taxes on behalf of the village. Generally the Bhoodan/Gramdan land allotted to the donees was legally not transferred to the donee and registered in his name. Therefore, the land revenue in most cases was paid to the government through the donor. Whenever there was reversion of Bhoodan/Gramdan land due to emigration of the donee, donee's death without an heir, non-fulfilment of donee's conditions, it was to the original donor and not to the Gramsabha. This showed that individualism was as strong in Gramdani villages as in non-Gramdani ones.

Generally the respondents including the Government officials expressed their view in favour of land redistribution. The respondents other than Government officials preferred Bhoodan/Gramdan method of land collection and redistribution. The Government

officials were in favour of legislative methods for this purpose.

There were some households except in successful Cluster I who were landless even after the redistribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan land. Heads of such households stated one or the other reasons for their being so, such as (i) did not receive any land; (ii) no money to purchase land; (iii) respondent immigrated to the village after the redistribution work was completed; (iv) no surplus land left after redistribution; and (v) the respondents were absent from the village at the time of redistribution of donated land. ●

Village Institutions

Formation and Function of the Gramsabha

The Gramsabha was to be constituted of all the adult members of a Gramdani village, the executive being elected unanimously. It had to work for cohesion and integration of village community, abolition of litigation, protection of crops, development of agriculture, cottage industries, health programme, education, social security etc.

In the district of Koraput Gramsabhas had existed even before Gramdan. Whosoever had the highest status in the village was accepted as the head of the Gramsabha. Civil, criminal and social disputes, along with other problems, were settled by the Gramsabha. After Gramdan, however, they were replaced with new Gramsabhas with a slightly different role and considerably extended functions.

It was hoped that Gramdani villages would provide an excellent training ground for direct democracy. Gramsabhas were to consist of all adult men and women of the village. The direction of all village activities was to have been taken over by them and they were to meet frequently for this purpose. They could, however, appoint ad-hoc committees for different activities like farming, marketing, organising village industries, etc.

The ownership of the entire village land was to rest in the Gramsabha and payment of revenue, taxes and other government dues was to be made by the Gramsabha from out of the collective fund known as Gramkosh. It was to function in the manner of the family and to look after the interests of all. The village would thus acquire a personality of its own.

How far were these hopes and expectations fulfilled? Were Gramsabhas formed in Gramdani village? Were they living institutions? How did they function? The results of our inquiry are described in the following pages.

2. Donees

The donees of the villages in Cluster I, both successful and unsuccessful said that no Gramsabha was functioning. All the donees in the four successful Clusters and in unsuccessful clusters II, IV and V said that Gramsabha was functioning in their villages. Thus no clear cut distinction could be made between a successful and an unsuccessful Gramdani village on the basis of the existence of Gramsabha. This is reflected in the following table.

Table 24

AWARENESS OF DONEES ABOUT THE GRAMSABHA AND ITS FUNCTIONS

	CI	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
1. No. of donees who said Gramsabha is functioning	—	5	5	7	7	24

2. No. of donees who said Gramsabha is not functioning	7	—	—	—	—	7
3. Functions mentioned:						
(i) Settlement of village disputes	—	4	3	5	4	16
(ii) Village Development and welfare	—	2	2	2	5	11
(iii) Distribution of land to the needy	—	1	—	—	—	1
(iv) Provision of loan	—	2	—	—	—	2
(v) To create community life	—	—	1	—	—	1
(vi) Mutual help	—	1	—	—	—	1
(vii) To organise festivals	—	—	—	2	—	2
(viii) To make plan for village	—	—	—	—	1	1
4. Unable to say	—	1	2	1	1	5

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

1. No. of donees who said Gramsabha is functioning	—	6	—	5	7	18
2. No. of donees who said Gramsabha is not functioning	5	—	5	—	—	10
3. Functions mentioned :						
(i) Settlement of village disputes	—	6	—	5	7	18

(ii) Village Development and welfare

— 6 — — 4 10

The donees of the successful clusters mentioned eight and those of the unsuccessful clusters only two functions of the Gramsabha of which settlement of village disputes was the uppermost. This function was, it seems, a carry over from the traditional Gramsabhas of the past. The second most important function was village development and welfare. None of the donees said that all the village was recorded in the name of the Gramsabha nor that land revenue/cess and other dues to the Government were being paid by the Gramsabha. Donors showed receipts of revenue and/or cess payments made by them individually. Our finding was that a sense of village ownership had not yet developed in Gramdani villages.

Office bearers of Gramsabhas

Sixteen Gramsabha office-bearers stated that Gramsabhas were formed in their villages and that they were functioning. They mentioned several functions being actually performed by them. Nine thought settlement of disputes in the village was the most important of these. Next in importance, mentioned by six, was looking after the welfare of the village people. Three office-bearers spoke of managing the Gramkosh, an equal number (in three of our sample villages) thought common cultivation as one of the functions of Gramsabha. Two mentioned development of the village and two organization of community work. One each specified construction of road and organization of festivals.

4. *Workers*

According to Gramdan/Bhoodan workers Gramsabhas were functioning in all the sample villages of cluster II, III, IV and V, except in Paliguda and in Yasada (both unsuccessful) where too they were formed but were not functioning. Two workers of cluster I said Gramsabha was functioning in village Dalua of unsuccessful cluster I. It was, however, found that only Prapti work had been done there; land had not been distributed and no Gramsabha was functioning. None of the donees mentioned it.

5. *Government officials :*

Most of the officials said they were not aware of the existence of Gramdani Gramsabhas. Only one stated that there were some such Gramsabhas.

GRAMKOSH

1. *Introduction*

In a Gramdani village sources of credit, both private and public, dry up. *Sahukars* and government officials alike fear that, ownership having been vested in the Gramsabha, an individual borrower cannot pledge his land in security and that even if he did, he could not be alienated from it in case of default. Establishment of Gramkosh and its effective functioning, therefore, assumes great importance in a Gramdani village. That is why it was laid down as one of the conditions of Gramdan that a Gramkosh should be instituted in a Gramdani village and that it should function as a wing of the Gramsabha. Its funds were to be raised in the following ways :

(i) Each cultivator to donate $1/40$ th of his annual agricultural produce;

(ii) A non-cultivator earner to donate $1/30$ th of his annual earnings.

(iii) A businessman to give $1/30$ th of what he takes away for family consumption; and

(iv) Monthly, yearly, or at any fixed interval.

Gramkosh was conceived of as the permanent capital of the village to be used to help capital formation and educational activities. Health and sanitation programmes were to be financed with the help of donations and voluntary labour.

One-twentieth of the Gramkosh was to be maintained in cash, leaving the rest for investments in loan, fixed assets, inventories and business and trade. Local variations could be made according to the need and resources.

The village population was to be divided into two or three sections, the poorest to be helped with loans for medicines, house construction and other necessities of life. Loans for production purposes were to be advanced at a concessional rate of interest, but slightly higher for the comparatively well-to-do cultivators. The poor were moreover to be given preference in the matter of loans. The well-to-do borrowers were to contribute to the Gramkosh a part of the profit made out of such loans.

II. Inquiries regarding Gramkosh were made from the donors, donees office-bearers of Gramsabha, workers and officials. Their responses are given below :

i. Donors

According to the donors, Gramkoshas were found

in clusters II, III, IV, V of the successful and cluster II of the unsuccessful varieties. Thus on the basis of the formation and functioning of Gramkosh no line could be drawn between successful and unsuccessful Gramdani villages.

Table 25**DONORS' AWARENESS OF EXISTENCE OF GRAMKOSH**

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Yes	—	5	7	6	5	23
No	5	—	2	—	—	7
Total	5	5	9	6	5	30
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
Yes	—	15	—	—	—	15
No	5	—	5	12	6	28
Total	5	15	5	12	6	43

Almost all the donors of the clusters in which Gramkosh existed were aware of the fact. In cluster III a Gramkosh, which was constituted but could not be managed well, was merged with the Grain Gola Scheme of the Government of Orissa. In the rest of the clusters not only was no Gramkosh functioning, but none had been formed except in Godiput of cluster IV. In Godiput some landless persons took loan from the Gramkosh and later left the village without repaying the loan and without even informing the villagers. The villagers lost faith in Gramkosh and it has not been revived since.

ii. Donees

All the donees of the clusters in which there were Gramkosh were found to be aware of their existence.

These clusters were the same as mentioned above in connection with donors' responses.

iii. Workers

The workers of all the clusters concerned corroborated the responses of the donors and donees of cluster I of both the varieties and those of unsuccessful cluster III, IV and V that no Gramkosh existed there.

V. Government officials

Government officials except one were found unaware of the existence of Gramkosh in the Gramdani villages. The one who knew said that Gramdan workers misused it, although he did not provide any evidence.

2. Contribution made to the Gramkosh

Donors and donees were asked if they had made any contribution, whether in cash or in kind, to the Gramkosh. Quite a large number of them said they had.

i. Donors

The following tables give an idea of donor's and donees' contribution.

Table 26

NO. OF DONORS WHO MADE CONTRIBUTIONS						
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	TOTAL
(i) Yes						
(ii) No	—	2	8	6	2	18
Total	5	3	1	—	3	12
	5	5	9	6	5	30

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

(i) Yes	—	12	—	—	—	12
(ii) No	5	3	5	12	6	31
Total	5	15	5	12	6	43

ii. Donees

Table 27

DONEES' CONTRIBUTION TO GRAMKOSH

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

No. of donees who made contribution.	—	4	3	7	6	20
No. of donees who did not make contribution	7	1	2	—	1	11
Total	7	5	5	7	7	31

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

No. of donees who made contribution	—	6	—	—	—	6
No. of donees who did not make contribution	5	—	5	5	7	22
Total	5	6	5	5	7	28

A higher proportion of donees than of donors contributed to the Gramkosh.

3. *Benefits derived*

Donors and donees were asked if they derived any benefits from Gramkosh in the form of loans. Their responses are tabulated below:—

i. Donors

Table 28

DONORS WHO DERIVED BENEFITES FROM GRAMKOSH

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) Yes	—	5	8	5	2	20

(ii) No	—	—	1	1	3	5
Total	—	5	9	6	5	25
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) Yes	9	—	—	—	—	9
(ii) No	6	—	—	—	—	6
Total	15	—	—	—	—	15
ii. Donees						

Table 29

NO. OF DONEES WHO DERIVED BENEFITS

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) No. of donees who derived benefits	—	4	3	7	7	21
(ii) No. of donees who did not derive benefits	7	1	2	—	—	10
Total	7	5	5	7	7	31
UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
(i) No. of donees who derived benefits	—	6	—	—	—	6
(ii) No. of donees who did not derive benefits	5	—	5	5	7	22
Total	5	6	5	5	7	28

Only three donees of successful clusters where Gramkosh existed did not borrow from Gramkosh.

4. Purpose of Loan

i. Donors

Inquiries revealed that about 50 per cent of the donors from the successful and eight from unsuccessful cluster III had taken loan for consumption purposes

in between harvests. Only one donor in cluster II (successful) borrowed seed.

ii. Donees

Twentyone donees from the successful clusters and six from the unsuccessful cluster II borrowed from the Gramkosh for purposes of consumption. Thus both donors and donees borrowed for consumption and not for investment. This shows either that production was not enough to sustain them in between harvests or that the loan was not properly used by them. Drinking was common in the sample villages of Koraput. People sold part of the produce to buy alchoholic drinks easily available, thanks to the policy of the Jan-Congress-Swantantra Government of Orissa. Workers failed to persuade the tribal people to voluntarily give up or reduce drinking.

FINANCE AND DEVELOPMENT

1. Sources of finance and special benefits derived after Bhoodan/Gramdan:

Eight donors in the successful clusters and 12 in the unsuccessful ones received institutional grants. Of the former six, from the block agency and two from the Bhoodan Samiti and of the latter one from the Block agency and eleven from the Bhoodan Samiti.

Fifteen donees from successful clusters and nine donees from unsuccessful ones were given grants. Four of the fifteen donees derived this benefit from the Bhoodan Samiti and eleven of them from the Block authority. Nine donees from the unsuccessful clusters were given grants by the Bhoodan Samiti.

The purposes for which these grants were given were: (i) purchase of bullocks, implements and seeds, and (ii) land reclamation.

Besides receiving grants, donors and donees borrowed money from various sources, the most important of which was Gramkosh. About two-thirds of the donors in the successful clusters borrowed from it and nearly all borrowers in the unsuccessful clusters turned to it for loans.

Four donors two each from successful clusters I and II borrowed from Sahukars and one (successful cluster I) from a rich friend of his. From the unsuccessful clusters only one donor was reported to have borrowed from the Sahukar.

Special benefits received after Bhoodan Gramdan were of no significance. One village was given a grant of Rs. 1,000/- for running a grain-gola and a co-operative store, none of which functioned for long. Other special benefits mentioned were cheap credit from the Gramkosh and abolition of the Goti system.

2. Developmental Activities

Bhoodan and Gramdan were expected to go beyond redistribution of land, formation of Gramsabha and Gramkosh to some village development work. Information in this behalf gathered from office-bearers of Gramsabhas and workers is noted below:—

Item of development work	No. of Office-bearers who mentioned.
(1) Wells dug	8
(2) Gramsabha building constructed	6
(3) Road construction	5

(4) Tank dug	4
(5) L. P. School started	4
(6) U. P. School started	2
(7) Bunding done	2
(8) Canal dug	2
(9) Common cultivation	2

No. of workers who mentioned

(1) Road construction	6
(2) Construction of embankment	3
(3) Wells dug	3
(4) Terracing and bunding	3
(5) Land reclaimed	2
(6) Gramsabha building constructed	2
(7) Community land cultivation	1
(8) Village school	1

Road construction, digging of wells and tanks were considered quite important. The Gramsabha building in one of the sample villages was crumbling, but the workers were not even aware of it until they visited the village along with us. We also discovered that a lower primary school that had been set up in the village was not functioning.

3. Promotion of Village Cohesiveness:—

There was a general expectation that Bhoodon/ Gramdan would bring about certain changes in the life of the village. Workers were asked what these were. From their responses, listed below, it appeared that some improvement had indeed taken place :

Item	No. of worker responded	
	Yes	No
(1) Augumenting village cohesion	10	1
(2) a. Ending fanctionalism	5	1

b. Factionalism reduced	5	—
(3) a. Ending litigation	4	2
b. Litigation reduced	5	—
(4) Improving the general atmosphere	10	1
(5) a. Reducing drunkenness	7	1
b. Not much drunkenness in Balasore	1	—
(6) Establishing mahila mandal	3	8
(7) Establishing youth club	6	5
(8) Informal get together	7	4

Some workers from Koraput sample villages felt that since the scrapping of prohibition drunkenness had increased.

SUMMARY :

No Gramsabha was formed in any of the villages of cluster I of both the varieties. There were Gramsabhas formed in the rest of the clusters of both the types. Generally these gramsabhas were performing traditional functions and none of the developmental functions like improvement of agriculture, establishment of industries, health, education, reduction of drunkenness etc.

Gramkosh was functioning in most of the villages of the tribal clusters of successful variety and cluster II of the unsuccessful variety. They were advancing loans in kind for consumption purposes only at the time of distress of the borrowers. Gramkosh reduced the importance and exploitation of Sahukars.

Only some villagers received loans and grants from the blocks for the purchase of bullocks, implements and seeds and for reclamation of land.

Outside agencies such as Block authorities, Khadi and village Industries Commission and Sarva Seva Sangh had done very little in the Gramdani villages.

Factionalism and litigation were claimed by the workers to have been reduced in Gramdani villages and general atmosphere of the village had improved.

Role of Bhoodan/Gramdan Workers and Deviations

Background Information

Age of the Workers

Six of the 11 workers were above 40 years of age and four belonged to the age group 25-40 years. Only one worker was below 25 years of age. This shows that new and young workers were no more joining the movement.

Literacy and Educational Standards of the Workers.

There were two workers who had passed Graduate or Post-Graduate examinations; three were educated upto High School; four upto Middle English School; and two were just literate. The movement obviously had not succeeded in attracting highly educated persons.

Previous Public Life of the Workers

Four of the workers had participated in the 1942 movement, three were members of the Congress, three were Khadi workers; and one had done some social work prior to joining the movement. It can be said the Bhoodan/Gramdan workers had the background of political or social work.

Motivations for Joining Bhoodan/Gramdan.

The workers were asked to give reasons for joining Bhoodan/Gramdan. They stated nine different

reasons. Five workers said that they worked for the movement so that land could be distributed among the needy, once land in Bhoodan/Gramdan was received. An equal number had done so for service of the nation and for love of social work. Four had been inspired by the speeches of Sarvodaya leaders. Three had joined to fight poverty. Three, who were full time Khadi workers, had been put to Bhoodan/Gramdan work. Two thought they could fight injustice and inequality through the movement. One of the workers thought that his belief in non-violence would get fulfilment in this kind of work while one was of the view that he could help village development through Bhoodan/Gramdan movement.

Methods adopted by the workers to obtain Bhoodan/Gramdan

The methods Bhoodan/Gramdan workers were expected to follow were : (i) approaching individuals and groups to canvass the principles and objectives of the movement; (ii) holding public meetings of villagers for this purpose, (iii) inviting Sarvodaya leaders and other prominent public workers sympathetic to the movement to speak to village people about it, (iv) requesting donors to persuade others in their own and neighbouring villages to follow their example; (v) recruiting the help of Gramdani villages to convince neighbouring villages of the desirability and benefits of Gramdan; (vi) going on *padayatra* to propagate the objectives of Gramdan and to obtain Gramdan; (vii) organising camps to train workers in methods of obtaining Bhoodan/Gramdan (viii) engaging in constructive work in rural areas to convince village people of the usefulness of Bhoodan/Gramdan, etc.

No worker employed all the methods, nor did all follow the same method, as is clear from the following table :—

Table 30

METHODS FOLLOWED BY WORKER

Bhoodan		Gramdan	
Method followed	No. of respondents mentioned.	Methods followed	No. of respondents mentioned.
(i) Organised meetings	5	(i) Organised meetings	7
(ii) Group persuasion	4	(ii) Group canvassing	6
(iii) Individual canvassing	2	(iii) Individual canvassing	3
(iv) Did padayatra	2	(iv) Did padayatra	2
(v) Invited leaders	1	(v) Invited leaders	2
(vi) Did constructive work	1	(vi) Did constructive work	1

Public meeting followed by group persuasion and individual canvassing was the most common method. Other methods were used by only a few. Workers depended upon their own local efforts rather than on out side agencies, such as constructive work furnished by Khadi and Village Industries Commission.

Although all the workers claimed to have received training at some camp or the other for Bhoodan/Gramdan work, no uniformity of method was to be seen in their work. In spite of the fact that there were

marked differences between adivasi and non-adivasi areas no differentiated approach to the two was shown. Different methods were followed by different workers in the same type of locality.

Deviations from the correct methods were noted in three cases, two in adivasi Gramdan villages, and the third in a non-adivasi Gramdan village. False promises of grants, loans or other kinds of benefits were made.

Official testimony in this regard was varied. While two of the five B. D. Os. interviewed said that Bhoodan/Gramdan was obtained through persuasion, three stated that false promises of loans and grants had been made. Another said that the workers, having no influence or moral authority of their own, had freely used Vinoba's name. Three other Tehsildars described the *modus operandi* thus: They (workers) collected the village folk at a place, took out their (village people's) records of land rights, entered them (records) in their (workers') papers and declared Bhoodan/Gramdan without actually explaining the meaning and implications of Bhoodan/Gramdan and without obtaining the consent of the villagers. In such cases the villagers would not even know that Gramdan had taken place. The Tehsildars added that the simple adivasis were made to give their thumb impressions on Bhoodan/Gramdan declaration without knowing what they were doing. One District Magistrate said that Bhoodan movement happened to be well timed in that, coinciding with Zamindari abolition, it found Zamindars, who anyway were going to be deprived of some of their land, favourably inclined towards mak-

ing donations. In one instance small pieces of waste land belonging to a Zamindar, which had been illegally occupied by some adivasis, mostly Santhals from outside the district of Balasore, donated them to Bhoodan when Zamindari abolition seemed imminent. The workers promptly marked them as Bhoodan land and entered the names of occupants as donees. In the opinion of another District Magistrate Bhoodan/Gramdan donations were obtained partly by persuasion and partly by fraud. He said that simple folk as the adivasis were, they could be easily made to agree even to things which might go against their interests. Not that he was opposed to the movement, he believed that genuine Bhoodan/Gramdan was beneficial to the village people, whether adivasi or non-adivasi.

The Section of the Village Community Approached first by the Workers

Sarvodaya is for the upliftment of all those who give and those who take. Some are supposed to gain spiritually by making sacrifices and others materially as they are also necessary to work as base for spiritual pursuits. Bhoodan/Gramdan movements were launched for the achievement of Sarvodaya Society. It comprehends the society in its entirety unlike some of the other movements such as Trade Unions or Communist movements. The workers are, therefore, expected to comprehend the entire society of the area or region in which they have engaged themselves for the success of Bhoodan/Gramdan movement. However, these workers were not in adequate number. They could not simultaneously

cover the entire village in which they were working. They had to approach some segment of the society or the other first and then gradually cover the rest. Bhoodan/Gramdan workers were asked which section of the rural society they approached first with the message of Bhoodan/Gramdan.

Their responses showed that two workers of Bhoodan and three of Gramdan had approached first the local leaders. An equal number had made the influential persons of the village their first choice. Only one worker thought it worth his while to contact big landlords first.

To make the movement a success workers naturally tried initially to enlist the support of those they considered most helpful and useful for establishing contact with and influencing others.

The Section of the village Community which in Workers' View Accepted Bhoodan first

Bhoodan leaders had estimated that about one-sixth of the Indian rural population was landless. Their call to landholders to donate at least one-sixth of their land for redistribution to the landless was based on this estimate. Workers were asked which section of the village community, in their view, was the first to accept this part of the Bhoodan programme.

Five workers named the rich and the middle farmers who accepted Bhoodan first for donating land. One said it was the middle farmers. Only one worker said in reply that the entire village community had responded simultaneously. Workers' responses were of course, based upon their respective field experiences.

The Section of the Village Community which in Workers' View Accepted Gramdan first.

In Gramdan of the Mangroth type the entire village and in that of Sulabh variety 75 per cent or more of the village population holding 51 per cent or more of village land were required to join. To find out if there was any particular section of the village community which was the first to accept the idea and from which it gradually spread to other sections of the population workers were interrogated.

There were four workers who said that all sections of the village community accepted the Gramdan at one and the same time. Five other respondents mentioned various sections such as rich farmers, middle farmers, middle and poor farmers, small farmers, and poor and landless.

At public meetings the entire audience usually responded positively to the call for Gramdan. The four workers might have had this experience in mind when they said that all sections had accepted Gramdan simultaneously. The other five might have been thinking of the exact manner in which Gramdan came to be eventually accepted.

Donor's Awareness of the Proportion of land to be Donated in Bhoodan/Gramdan.

Although a large number of donors had actually donated more than the prescribed minimum, none of them was aware of what the minimum was. This shows the failure of workers to impart the basic information.

Help or Impediments in Bhoodan/Gramdan

Workers' experience of what helped or what hindered them is listed below :

Table 31

**HELP OR OBSTACLES FACED BY WORKERS IN
BHOODAN WORK**

KIND OF HELP	NO. OF WORKERS RESPONDED.	KIND OF OBSTACLE	NO. OF WORKERS RESPONDED
1. Villagers : in hold- ing meeting	1	1. Donors sometimes changed their mind and withdrew dona- tions. Such donors made propaganda against Bhoodan.	2
2. Workers : in orga- nising meeting and canvassing	3	2. Government offi- cials did not help in the solution of Bhoodan land dis- puted	3
3. Rich farmers in some cases gave land and came to the meeting	3		
4. Government offi- cials earlier helped the movement.	2		

**HELP OR OBSTACLES FACED BY WORKERS IN
GRAMDAN WORK**

KIND OF HELP	NO. OF WORKERS RESPONDED	KIND OF OBSTACLE	NO. OF WORKERS RESPONDED
1. Villagers : in hold- ing meeting	3	1. Some rich farmers persuaded the people not to co-operate with the Gramdan.	4
2. Workers : in orga- nising meetings and canvassing	5	2. Government officials would i. Spread rumours that they would lose the right to culti- vate the land if joined Gramdan	3

- | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3. Rich farmers in some cases gave land and came to the meeting | 4 | ii. Stop loans and grants to the gramdani villages | 4 |
| 4. Government officials earlier helped the movement | 3 | iii. Help Sahukars to file suits against Gramdani villages and to obstruct irrigation channel to discourage Gramdan. | 4 |
| | | iv. During 21-10-56 to 25-2-61 and since April 1967 oppose the Gramdan movement by rejecting applications for confirmation | 2 |
| | | v. Delay confirmation of Gramdans | 3 |
| | | vi. Say that they would accept Gramdan if all the land of the village came in Gramdan | 4 |
| | | vii. Not issue <i>pattas</i> . | 3 |
| | | viii. Tehsildars do not care to know the situation of the villages and their distance and therefore call the villagers for transfer of title deeds to great distances and quite often announce change | |

of date for the purpose after the villagers arrive at the Tehsildar's camps. This is again and again repeated.

4

ix. Forest officials obstruct cutting of forest wood for fire and house construction

3

x. Government policy of abolishing prohibition increased drunkenness and waste of money and energy by villagers. This hinders development in Gramdani villages.

3

xi Government policy now hostile

3

The above shows that Government officials in many ways had obstructed the Bhoodan/Gramdan movement.

Distribution of Land :

Workers

The following procedure was to be followed for redistribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan land.

Bhoodan

- (i) The Bhoodan Nivedak, who was authorized by the Bhoodan Yajna Samiti to redistribute

land received in donations, and the amins who helped him in the survey work were to visit the village after giving previous notice to the villagers about the proposed redistribution.

- (ii) A general meeting of the villagers was to be held to identify the landless persons in the village.
- (iii) The distribution of land was then to be made in consultation with the villagers.
- (iv) As far as possible, allotments of land were to be made by a unanimous decision of the village. If there was difference of opinion with regard to any allotment, the Bhoodan Nivedak or any other authorized representative of the Bhoodan Yajna Samiti was to give his final verdict.
- (v) Land was to be given, as far as possible, to the landless persons of the same village. The surplus, if any, could be allotted to the landless of the neighbouring villages.
- (vi) In general, allotted land was for personal cultivation.
- (vii) The persons authorized to redistribute land had to explain to the villagers that the allotted land was not to be mortgaged except to the Government or to a co-operative society with the specific purpose of raising a loan, nor was it to be sold. They were further to explain to the 'grantee' (donee) that he was liable to the Government for land revenue as from the date of allotment.

- (viii) Wherever a big plot was available it was to be given to a group of persons in the village itself for the purpose of cultivation.
- (ix) Land was also to be given to the villagers jointly if necessary for community purpose in the village.
- (x) A period of three years was to be allowed to bring fallow or uncultivated land under cultivation.

Gramdan

The following procedure was to be generally followed while redistributing land in Gramdan villages :—

- (i) The Gramdan village itself was to fix the principles of redistribution, Bhoodan/Gramdan workers helping them with advice and in technical matters.
- (ii) Full rights of cultivation were given to the 'grantee' (donee) on the clear understanding that ownership of land did not pass to him but was vested in the village community.
- (iii) The individual farmer was not to sell or mortgage his holdings.
- (iv) The village community reserved to itself the right to have periodical reallootments, say every five or ten years.
- (v) The Orissa Bhoodan Act as amended recognized communal ownership of land in Gramdan villages.
- (vi) A certain part of land in some villages was to be set apart for collective farming only

after all the landless in the village had come to have land.

- (vii) If a person in a Gramdan village was landless, land could be allotted to him by villagers and workers even if he happened to be a relation of the donor.

Bhoothan/Gramdan workers were enjoined to clearly state the basic points to be kept in view in the course of redistribution of Bhoothan/Gramdan land. Did the workers themselves understand the basic principles? And were the prescribed procedures followed in actual practice? The answers that were obtained from the workers of the sample are given below :—

BASIC POINT	NO. OF WORKERS MAINTAINED	
	BHOODAN	GRAMDAN
(i) Priority to landless Harijan and Adivasis		
(ii) To those with little land	5	7
(iii) Artisan	3	6
(iv) Size of the family of landless	1	—
(v) For common cultivation	—	1
	—	3

Workers' Responses Regarding the Process of Distribution of Bhoothan/Gramdan Land :

Bhoothan

According to one Bhoothan worker a meeting of the inhabitants of the village was called at which a committee was formed to decide the names of allottees and the quantum of land to be allotted to each. Thus it was the committee which distributed land to the donees. Another worker stated that a list of the

landless households of the village was prepared by the Bhoodan workers and land was allotted to them by the workers. A third said that in some areas Bhoodan land was distributed by ad-hoc Gramsabhas. One of the workers said that Bhoodan workers distributed the donated land without actually surveying the land, the result being that on the one hand, the donee did not know where the plot of land allotted to him was situated, and on the other, in some cases the same plot of land was allotted to more than one donee. Thus it was found that workers' responses in this regard were not uniform.

Gramdan

Seven Gramdan workers said that Gramdan land was distributed through machinery of the Gramsabha. The Gramsabha prepared the list of donees and donated the land to them.

(a) Block Development Officers' Views

Four of the five B. D. O.s had no knowledge and no views in this regard because, they said, transfer of land was none of their concern. The fifth said that Bhoodan/Gramdan workers had distributed the donated land as they liked without reference to any principles.

(b) Tehsildars

Although title in land was of direct concern to Tehsildars, all of them said they were unaware of any principles of Bhoodan/Gramdan redistribution of land.

(c) District Magistrates

One of the District Magistrates said that since donated land was redistributed with the help of the

Government, there was no scope for malpractices or fraud on the part of workers. The other was of the view that quite often donors, on the pretext of Gramdan were persuaded by workers to divide the land among their family members to evade registration fees but he admitted that in some cases Bhoodan/Gramdan land had been distributed on the basis of some principles.

**Difficulties faced by Workers in
Distribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan Land.**

(a) Bhoodan

Three workers from the Baliapal block (Balasore district), who were mostly concerned with Bhoodan gave three different responses. One had faced two types of difficulties. One arose from the fact that in some cases donors had donated village pasture land which the donee was naturally prevented from bringing under cultivation. The other was rather more serious. Government officials, he said, had either failed or refused to legalize the transfers by registering them in their records and issuing *pattas* in the names of the donees, who consequently felt insecure and were reluctant to invest in the improvement of land donated to them. In the absence of transfer of legal ownership donors sometimes took back the land from the donees. The second worker said he did not encounter any difficulties and the third had nothing to do with redistribution of donated land.

(b) Gramdan

Four of the workers in Gramdani areas had not found any difficulty in distribution of Gramdan land. Four other workers, however, had. Two had found

there were not enough amins to help in the distribution work. One thought that *pattas* relating to the allotted land were not made available to the donees and consequently they felt insecure. Two workers mentioned the role of *Sahukars* who went about telling donors that if they confirmed the Gramdan they would lose ownership and inheritance rights. Two workers pointed to the manner in which Tehsildars functioned. Generally ignorant of the location of the villages concerned, they would set up camp anywhere and summon donors and donees from far away villages to decide transfer of title deeds relating to donated land. And they came from long distances only to be told more often than not that their cases had been adjourned to the next camp of the Tehsildar at some other village. Both donors and donees viewed this as unnecessary harassment and delay.

(ii) Government Officials

Block Development Officers had no difficulties for the simple reason that they were not concerned with redistribution of Bhoodan/Gramdan land.

Tehsildars, who had to deal with transfers of title deeds did mention several difficulties. One thing, however, which they did not mention but which came out in the course of interviews with them was that most of them were ignorant of the Orissa Bhoodan Act and possibly other pieces of legislation relating to Bhoodan/Gramdan. This ignorance might have had its birth in their indifference to the whole movement.

One Tehsildar had found that applications for transfer of title deeds were not accompanied by all the relevant documents and also that often the same piece

of land had been allotted by Bhoodan workers to more than one person. Delay in both cases he pointed out was unavoidable, but in the latter was far greater because nothing could be done till the final outcome of the resultant litigation.

Another Tehsildar had felt handicapped because he was not empowered by the Bhoodan Act to summon Nivedakas or Bhoodan/Gramdan workers to his court and they did not take the trouble on their own of appearing with the parties concerned to help correct records, if necessary so as to obviate delays. It was the experience of two Tehsildars that Nivedakas themselves often made false or incorrect declarations making it difficult to sift facts and set the records straight. One said his work-load was too much to allow him to devote adequate attention to Gramdan land transfers. There was one Tehsildar who was wholly innocent of redistribution work.

Opinion about Bhoodan/Gramdan Movement, Bhoodan/Gramdan Workers, Khadi Institutions, etc :

Two sets of respondents, donors and donees, were requested to give their opinions regarding Bhoodan/Gramdan. They are listed below:—

1. *About Bhoodan.*

(i) Donors' Opinions.

Three donors in the successful cluster I stated that it was a good movement in that some landless households had benefited from it. Two donors in the successful cluster I said the movement was good but workers had adopted corrupt practices and embezzled money. No evidence was adduced in support of the allegation.

(ii) Donees' opinion

Four donees in the successful cluster I stated that movement had resulted in land being allotted to the landless and the needy of the village.

2. About Gramdan

(i) Donors' opinion

Table 32

DONORS' OPINION ABOUT GRAMDAN

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
SUCCESSFUL						
1. Landless got land	-	-	3	3	3	9
2. Community life possible through Gramdan	2	3	-	-	-	5
3. Development of Community ownership of land	-	-	1	-	2	3
4. Unable to state	-	-	-	-	-	-
5. No response	-	-	-	-	-	-
UNSUCCESSFUL						
1. Landless got land	2	6	-	-	-	8
2. Community ownership of land	-	1	2	3	-	6
3. Helped the villagers in providing monetary and other needs	-	1	-	3	-	4
4. Good movement not properly implemented	2	-	-	-	-	2

It will be seen from the above table that in the opinion of donors the most important feature of Gramdan was that the landless got land. Some saw it as having fostered the idea of common ownership of land and community life in the villages.

ii. Donees' opinion

Table 33

DONEES' OPINION ABOUT GRAMDAN

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
SUCCESSFUL						
1. Land allotted to the landless	—	2	2	2	1	7
2. Community feeling	—	1	—	—	2	3
UNSUCCESSFUL						
1. Land allotted to the landless	3	5	—	1	1	10
2. Benefited the people	2	—	—	—	—	2
3. Community feeling introduced	—	—	1	1	—	2

Only a few donees expressed their opinion, but those who did corroborated the opinion of donees about allotment of land to the landless.

About Bhoodan/Gramdan workers

The image of Bhoodan/Gramdan workers in the minds of donors, donees and Government Officials is brought out below:—

Donors' Opinion

Table 34

DONORS' OPINION ABOUT WORKERS

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
SUCCESSFUL						
1. Working for the welfare of poor	2	3	7	6	5	23

Working for peace and prosperity of the village	-	2	-	-	-	2
3. Did good work in the beginning but not now	-	-	2	-	-	2
4. Workers corrupt and embezzle money	3	-	-	-	-	3
UNSUCCESSFUL						
1. Working for the welfare of poor	1	14	2	12	6	35
2. The workers did good work in the beginning but not now	3	-	2	-	-	5

It is clear from table 34 that most donors were of the view that Bhoodan/Gramdan workers had worked for the benefit of the poor and thus only for a section rather than for the entire village community. In cluster I, both successful and unsuccessful, some donors expressed an adverse opinion about the workers.

ii. Donees' Opinion

The sample donees also gave a variety of opinions regarding the Bhoodan/Gramdan workers. Their responses are given in the following table.

Table 35

DONEES' OPINION ABOUT WORKERS

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS						
1. Workers help the poor villagers	2	2	4	1	6	15

2. Working for village development	-	3	1	5	-	9
3. Working for the development of community feeling	-	-	-	1	-	1
4. Workers demand bribe in cash or kind to effect legal transfer of donated land	2	-	-	-	-	2
5. Workers are corrupt	1	-	-	-	-	1
6. Workers give false assurances	1	-	-	-	-	1

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS

1. Workers' help the poor villagers	-	6	1	3	7	17
2. Workers showing lack of interest in land distribution	5	-	-	-	-	5
3. Workers not visiting the village after Gramdan	-	-	2	-	-	2

A large number of donees stated that workers had helped the poor of the village. Nine donees in the successful clusters were of the view that workers had attempted the development of the whole village. The opinion of some of the donees in cluster I of both the types were unfavourable to workers. In the successful variety they said that workers were corrupt, that they had demanded illegal gratification, and that they had given false assurances. In the unsuccessful variety the critics alleged that workers

were not interested in land redistribution and that they had declared some persons as donees without actually allotting them any land.

iii. Government Officials' Opinion

Government officials were requested to state their views under six heads: (a) General conduct and human relations; (b) Propensity to corruption, (c) Moral character; (d) Proneness to violence; (e) Association with violent activities of the Naxalites and (f) Instances of conflict. Their responses are noted below:

(a) General Conduct and Human Relations:

Two B. D. Os. stated, one on the basis of personal experience and the other on hearsay evidence, that Bhoodan/Gramdan workers had the knack of mixing with the people easily. The latter added that having gained the confidence of illiterate villagers workers inveigled them into Gramdan. One B. D. O. thought that Bhoodan/Gramdan workers served the political interests of some person or the other and therefore had made efforts to influence people politically. The remaining two B. D. Os. frankly said that they were not in touch with workers and were, therefore, unable to hazard any opinion about them.

One of the Tehsildars asserted that Bhoodan/Gramdan workers had made false promises to obtain Gramdan, had affiliations with political parties and had made efforts to influence voters in the elections. According to him, they were looked down upon with contempt by the discerning. It may be mentioned paranthetically that only one worker was found to be a member of a political party. One Tehsildar was of the view that the conduct of workers was not bad. Three did

not express any opinion as they were not in contact with the workers and did not know much about them.

One of the D. Ms. said that workers' general conduct and attitude towards the people was good while the other opined that some workers were good and others bad, like workers in other walks of life.

(b) Propensity to Corruption.

Two B. D. Os. had not heard of any charges of corruption against Bhoodan/Gramdan workers. Three of them said they had been told that some workers had embezzled the organisation's money for personal use. However, they did not substantiate their statements.

Among the Tehsildars one had no reason to suspect workers of any propensity to corruption. Three said that although they had heard of corruption on the part of the workers, they had no personal knowledge and could not therefore vouchsafe for the correctness of the charge. In the opinion of yet another, however, corruption was rampant among them. He elaborated it by enumerating several forms of corruption. For example, in the course of redistribution they had deliberately donated the same piece of land to more than one donee, possibly on consideration. Again, in cases of delay in the transfer of title deeds relating to donated land they had extorted bribes, in cash or in kind, from donees on promise of expediting the finalization of transfers. They had allotted some communal land, donated by Zamindars at the time of Zamindari abolition, to individual donees. All these, he asserted had resulted in an enormous increase in litigation in the area. The workers have, in view of the Tehsildar, in many cases, allotted large tracts of sandy uncultiv-

able land, received in Bhoodan, to the donees along the coastal areas. It was not possible for the donees to locate these plots. The Tehsildar further stated that funds allotted for the purpose of reclamation of donated land had been given to false donees in a number of cases. The remaining three Tehsildars said that they had heard of corruption of the workers but they confessed that they were not in a position to substantiate the same.

While one of the District Magistrates was of the view that there was no propensity to corruption in the Bhoodan/Gramdan workers, the other District Magistrate said that the propensity to corruption among the Bhoodan/Gramdan workers was as much as in any other aspect of national life. He, however, did not cite any specific instances.

(c) *Moral Character*

Of the Government officials five had nothing against the moral character of workers and one said that in some cases it was good and in some other cases bad. The remaining five officials had heard adverse reports but had no specific instances.

(d) *Proneness to Violence*

Eight government officials said that there was no proneness to violence among Bhoodan/Gramdan workers. One had nothing to say. Two had heard of it but had no personal knowledge. One official charged them with instigation of violence though not direct participation. He gave the specific example of the sample village of Mali Bhimdol where a forest guard was beaten by the villagers at the instigation of Bhoodan/Gramdan workers when he objected to their cutting of forest wood.

(e) *Bhoodan/Gramdan Workers' Association with Violent Activities of Naxalites.*

All the Government officials except one denied the occurrence of violent activities of Naxalite type in their area. The one who was an exception said that he had received information, which had not yet been confirmed, that one Naxalite from outside the Koraput district had come to Nandpur block and was trying to organise the tribal people on Naxalite lines. Ten of the officials categorically stated that Bhoodan/Gramdan workers were not at all inclined towards Naxalite activities. One official thought that in the absence of Naxalite activities in the area there was no possibility of workers taking part in them. Another said that Bhoodan/Gramdan workers were not trained for such activities and were not capable of participating in them.

(f) *Instances of Conflict Arising from Bhoodan/Gramdan.*

None of the Government officials could say whether any conflicts between two factions of the village had taken place in the course of or arising from Bhoodan/Gramdan.

SUMMARY

Generally the workers were 25 years of age or above, majority being over 40 years.

Two of the workers had passed Graduate or post-Graduate examinations. The rest were educated upto High School or less.

Most of the workers were in political parties before joining Bhoodan/Gramdan. They joined this move-

ment for various reasons such as redistribution of land among the needy, service of the nation, social work, fighting poverty, injustice and inequality and for village development.

They approached individuals and groups for obtaining Bhoodan/Gramdan held meetings, did padayatra, organised camps for workers and did constructive work to persuade people of the village for Bhoodan/Gramdan.

Generally the Government officials held the view that Bhoodan/Gramdan were obtained by the workers through false promises and fraud.

The influential persons of the village community were first approached by the workers for Bhoodan/Gramdan. Generally the rich and middle farmers accepted the movement first.

None of the donors were aware that 1/6th of their land was to be donated in Bhoodan and 1/20th in Gramdan. However, a large number of them had actually donated more than the required minimum.

The workers got many kinds of helps and faced many obstacles in the course of their work—help from villagers in holding meetings, from workers in organising meetings, from rich farmers land and attendance of the meeting.

The workers faced many kinds of difficulties also, such as: (i) Donors sometimes changed their mind and withdrew donation; such donors made propaganda against Bhoodan/Gramdan; (ii) Government officials spread rumours that the landowners would lose the right to cultivate the land if they joined Gramdan; (iii) Government stopped loans and grants to the gramdani

villages; (iv) Government officials would help *sahukars* to file suits against Gramdani villages to obstruct irigation channel to discourage Gramdan; (v) Government officials delayed confirmation of Gramdans and would not issue *pattas*, (vi) Forest officials would obstruct the cutting of forest wood for fire and house construction; (vii) Government since 1967 had abolished prohibition which has increased drunkenness among the adivasis resulting in dissipation of savings, time and energy and (viii) Government policy was hostile to Bhoodan/Gramdan at the time of the field work.

Tehsildars said that the documents for the transfer of title deeds of donated land were generally not accompanied by all the relevant papers to facilitate the transfer. One Tehsildar said that the same piece of Bhoodan land was allotted by the Bhoodan authorities to more than one person which led to litigation and delay in transfer of donated land.

The donors and donees generally had high opinion of the movement and workers. Some of them, however, said that the workers adopted corrupt practices and embezzled money. This view was not substantiated.

Most of the government officials had an adverse opinion of the workers. However, they could not substantiate their charges.

The government officials said that the workers had no proneness to violence and did not participate in Naxalite activities. ●

Summary of Findings and Recommendations

The study was conducted in the districts of Balasore and Koraput which topped the list of Bhoodan and Gramdan donations in orissa.

Balasore was predominantly a non-tribal and Koraput a tribal district. Both the districts were preponderantly agricultural, Balasore even more than Koraput. The percentage of literacy in Koraput was much lower than in Balasore.

The area where field work was done was divided into two clusters; successful and unsuccessful. A successful cluster was one where land received in donations had actually been redistributed and a Gramsabha and a Gramkosh had started functioning. In Balasore, however, neither Gramsabha nor Gramkosh existed even in the successful clusters. There the work had been mainly extensive and had stopped at the stage of Prapti, i. e., declaration. There being no distinction between successful and unsuccessful clusters, they were all classed unsuccessful. In Koraput land redistribution had been completed and Gramsabha and Gramkosh were functioning in most villages of the successful clusters.

Donors had donated land voluntarily and without any coercion from workers or for fear of legislation or Naxalite movement.

Land was donated to ad-hoc Gramsabhas at the meetings of the villagers. Donors had generally donated more than the required minimum.

The donated land was distributed, by and large, through the machinery of the Gramsabha.

The beneficiaries were the needy and landless agricultural households of those who possessed very little land. In a large number of villages, however, there still were some landless agricultural households. Consequently in no sample village with the exception of one had any land been retained by the Gramsabha for common cultivation.

Periodic redistribution of land with the object of achieving for the establishment of near equality had not been achieved.

Most of the respondents who did not belong to the Government were in favour of land redistribution through the agency of Bhoodan and Gramdan. Government officials, however, were in favour of redistribution through legislative measures.

Gramsabhas generally were performing the functions they had traditionally performed prior to Bhoodan/Gramdan. They could not plan for village development due to paucity of funds and trained personnel at the district, tehsil, and village levels.

Land revenues and cess were paid by individuals and not by the Gramsabha as contemplated in Gramdan.

There were cases of reversion of donated and redistributed land to the original landholder but not to the Gramsabha. This showed lack of community spirit in Gramdan villages.

Villagers had borrowed from the Gramkosh for consumption purposes and to that extent had been freed from the exploitation of money lenders. Government, Khadi and Village Industries Commission and Sarva Seva Sangh had done little to help Gramdani villages develop fully.

Workers had failed (i) to persuade villagers to send their wards to schools even where schooling facilities existed; (ii) to reduce drunkenness which led to dissipation of savings, among adivasis, and (iii) to persuade adivasis to use well water where it was available. Use of traditional dirty sources of water contributed to bad health.

Most Government officials at different levels were either ignorant of, or indifferent or hostile to the movement. Even Tehsildars, who are closely associated with land allotment and registration were, ignorant of the provisions of the Orissa Bhoodan Act.

Bhoodan/Gramdan workers in both areas were helpful and sympathetic carriers of change and were generally recognised as such by the people at large. Workers were very few in number. They lacked sufficient education and training for the work they were called upon to do.

Different categories of respondents including Government officials were of the view that workers had nothing to do with Naxalite activities. This study relates to the areas covered. However, it shows the broad trends.

Recommendations

1. Workers are one of the most important factors at all the stages of Bhoodan/Gramdan movement, but espe-

cially for the creation of a favourable climate, individual and collective approaches, meetings, declaration of Bhoodan/Gramdan, confirmation and redistribution of land, formation of Gramsabhas and Gramkosh, and development of the villages. Their number should be augmented and their quality improved through training and study classes. Some from the Bhoodan/Gramdan villages, who are interested in this work, should be properly trained in village and area development work so as to create a local cadre.

A course of training should be prepared to teach them a little of Sociology, Political Science and Economic Planning and to make them conversant with the norms of the movement and the appropriate code of conduct so that they may be better equipped and more respected than political workers and officials and also so that they may be competent for planning not only at the village but also at the tehsil and district levels.

2. Although it is all right to set targets for obtaining Bhoodan/Gramdan, more emphasis should be put on distribution of land and the development of the villages, the block, the tehsil and the district than on declarations of Bhoodan/Gramdan. Villagers should be educated through the spoken and the written words, visual aids and frequent classes and training camps.

3. An act should be passed to expedite registration of Gramdani village, formation of Gramsabha and Gramkosh, legal transfer of Bhoodan/Gramdan land, and collection of land revenues, cess and other taxes from the Gramsabha.

4. Gramsabha should be formed in each Gramdani village to perform different functions, development

of the village, creation of a climate for community life, looking after the weaker sections of the village, persuading people to send their children to school, reducing drunkenness, smoking, etc., encouraging savings and investments, diversifying agriculture through dairy farming, poultry farming, piggery, starting industries which can use local resources and meet local demands.

5. For diversification of the economy decisions at macro and micro levels and real acceptance and implementation of common production programme advocated by the Government of India during the Second Five-year plan are necessary; otherwise village industries such as gur and khandsari making, oil pressing, paddy pounding, etc, will collapse.

6. A powerful propaganda machinery should be built up for publicizing the achievements of the movement so that people may not be ignorant of the impact of Bhoodan/Gramdan. Members of State Legislatures and of Parliament should be made familiar with the work of the movement and with various programmes and requirements.

7. A list of leader farmers who are likely to accept change and active sympathisers of Bhoodan/Gramdan should be prepared to persuade them for the acceptance of improved methods of agriculture and village industries and to work for community effort.

8. A Gramkosh as a wing of Gramsabha should be organised where it does not exist and strengthened where it does with the twin purpose of encouraging savings and advancing loans to villagers in times of need, whether of production or of consumption so as to save them from the clutches of the money lenders.

9. A Shanti Sena, also as a wing of Gramsabha, should be formed to look after the crops, to teach people a better way of life by reducing expenditures on drinks and religious and ceremonial rituals and by making use of well water for cooking and drinking, etc.

10. A Bhoodan/Gramdan Sangh at block, tehsil and district levels should be organized to which Gramsabhas at lower levels should be affiliated so as to pave the way for a statewide institution and eventually for our all India body. It would be their function to explore the possibility of and procure external aid, but, more importantly, to mobilise internal resources. This Sangh will help the Gramdan villages, Gramdan blocks, Gramdan districts and States to plan for themselves.

11. Different kinds of co-operatives should be organised for developing industries and for running consumer stores to provide needed goods to villagers at fair prices. This will be a good training ground for co-operative practices and will also develop the managerial talents of the village people.

12. In view of the fact that government authorities at different levels discriminate against the Bhoodan/Gramdan villages in the matter of aid and grant for fear of increasing people's power at the cost of their influence and authority, it may be necessary to organise peaceful demonstrations and agitations in protest.

Appendix—1

Land donated and distributed Statewise Statistics till July 1970

States	Land received acres	No. of doners	Land distributed acres	Grantees Written off acres	Remaining land acres
Assam	11935.00	7344	265.00	—	11670.00
Andhra Pradesh	241952.00	16627	103351.00	22733	52216.00
Orissa	185782.80	84456	96463.96	42614	89318.84
Uttar Pradesh	435457.54	38296	210090.73	73318	23733.41
Kerala	26293.00	—	5774.00	—	12520.00
Tamilnadu	51330.00	21899	16394.00	11153	34936.00
Delhi	300.00	—	180.00	—	—
Panjab-Haryana	14739.00	—	3601.00	—	120.00
Gujarat	103530.21	18327	50924.28	10270	3380.00
Maharashtra	105094.24	19953	70950.27	15199	52605.93
Madhya Pradesh	405786.13	58375	173062.89	47445	30828.17
Mysore	15864.00	5017	2123.00	941	176246.28
West Bengal	12960.00	—	3898.00	—	13741.00
Bihar	2117467.00	290200	391400.00	224850	636.00
Rajasthan	432868.00	8391	84781.00	13158	411372.00
Himachal Pradesh	5240.00	—	2531.00	—	225598.00
Jammu & Kashmir	211.00	—	5.00	—	2709.00
Total	4166809.92	568885	1215795.13	461681	206.00
				1854882.17	1146094.63

Source : Diary, Sarva Seva Sangh Prakashan, Rajghat, Varanasi.

Appendix—2

Gramdan till 31st July 1970

States	Gramdan	Prakhand-dan	Zila-dan
Bihar	60065	573	15
Tamilnadu	30605	314	11
Uttar Pradesh	32963	186	8
Orissa	12636	70	2
Madhya Pradesh	10889	47	7
Andhra Pradesh	4231	15	1
Maharashtra	4625	17	1
Mysore	1922	14	1
Rajasthan	2067	2	1
Punjab-Haryana	4011	7	—
Assam	1682	1	—
Gujrat	1119	3	—
West Bengal	748	—	—
Kerala	418	—	—
Delhi	74	—	—
Jammu & Kashmir	1	—	—
Total	168056	1249	47

Source : Diary 1971, Sarva Seva Sangh, Prakashan.

Appendix—3 A

CLUSTER I (SUCCESSFULL) :—

Castes	Total No. of House- holds	Donors	Donees	Land owning non- donors	Landless house- holds	Sample Donors	Sample Donees	Sample land- owning non- donors	Sample landless house-hold.
Non-Tribal									
1. Brahmin	8	1	2	5	—	1	—	1	—
2. Jogi	2	—	1	1	—	—	2	—	—
3. Karan	2	—	—	2	—	—	—	—	—
4. Khandayat	19	1	2	14	2	2	—	3	1
5. Machhua	1	—	1	—	—	—	—	—	—
6. Muslim	3	1	1	1	—	1	1	—	1
7. Raju	11	4	3	4	—	1	—	—	—
8. Saha	2	—	—	2	—	—	—	—	—
9. S. C.	15	—	10	4	1	—	2	—	—
10. Teli	2	—	—	2	—	—	—	3	—
11. Vaisya	38	—	4	33	1	—	—	4	—
12. Vaishnava	2	—	—	2	—	—	—	—	—
Sub-Total	105	7	24	70	4	5	5	11	4
Tribal									
1. Kaiberta	2	—	—	—	2	—	—	—	1
2. Santhal	10	—	4	6	—	—	2	1	—
Sub-Total	12	—	4	6	2	—	2	1	1
Grand Total	117	7	28	76	6	5	7	12	5

Appendix—3 B

CLUSTER 1 (UNSUCCESSFUL) :—

Castes	Total No. of House Holds	Total No. of donees	Total No. of Non- donors	Total No. of Land- less	No. of Sahu- kars	No. of Sample donees	No. of Sample donors	No. of Sample landless Non-do- nors	No. of Sample house- holds
Non-Tribal									
1. Brahmin	6			4				2	
2. Karan	6	4	1	1	1			1	
3. Khandayat	3	2	1	1				1	
4. Kumhar	1		1	1					
5. Muslim	19		4	13	2				2
6. Raju	16	5	4	6	3		4		2
7. Scheduled castes	14	4		6				1	1
8. Teli	2	2				1			
9. Vaisya	12	1	1	6			1	1	1
Sub-Total	79	16	8	29	2	5	5	6	6
Tribal									
Santhal	13	—	—	3	10	—	—	—	1
Grand- Total	92	16	8	32	35	2	5	6	7

Appendix—4 A

CLUSTER II (SUCCESSFUL) :—

	Total No. of House- holds	Donors	Land owning non-do nors	Landless house- holds	Sample donors	Sample donees	Sample Land- owning non- donors	Sample land- less house- holds.
Non-Tribal								
Kolar	2	-	2	-	-	-	1	-
Kumhar	7	-	2	4	-	-	-	-
Lohar	5	-	-	4	-	1	-	2
Mali	2	-	-	2	-	-	-	-
Yadava	5	2	-	2	1	-	-	-
Vaisya	3	-	-	2	-	1	-	-
Sub-Total	24	2	4	14	1	2	1	2
Tribal								
Bhotra	85	17	46	15	4	2	11	6
Gond	4	1	2	1	-	1	-	-
Gauda	1	-	-	1	-	-	-	-
Naik	3	1	2	1	-	-	-	-
Pujari	1	-	1	1	-	-	-	-
Sub-Total	94	18	51	17	4	3	11	6
Grand- Total	118	20	55	31	5	5	12	8

Appendix-4 B

CLUSTER II (UNSUCCESSFUL):—

Castes	Total No. of House holds	Total No. of donees	Total No. of non- donors	Total No. of Landless Households	No. of Sample donors	No. of Sample donees	No. of Sample non- donors	No. of Land- less Sample households.
Tribal								
Banjara	7	4		3		2		1
Bhotra	75	14	24	3	7	1	1	2
Bindhani	5	—	5	—	—	—	—	—
Gauda	24	2	5	1	4	—	1	—
Kolar	22	10	6	1	4	3	3	—
Paika	3	—	—	3	—	—	—	1
Parja	1	—	1	—	—	—	—	—
Sub Total	137	25	41	11	15	6	5	4
Non-Tribal								
Scheduled Castes	12	1	10	1	—	—	7	1
Yadava	3	—	2	1	—	—	—	—
Sub Total	15	1	12	2	—	—	7	1
Grand Total	152	26	53	13	15	6	12	5

Appendix-5 A

CLUSTER III (SUCCESSFUL) :—

Castes	Total No. of House-holds	Donors	Donees	Land owning non-donors	Land-less house-holds	Sample donors	Sample donees	Sample land owning non-donors.	Sample Land-less house-holds.
Non-Tribal									
1. Kamar	3	1	1	—	1	—	—	—	—
2. Mali	8	1	2	—	5	—	—	2	4
3. Rona	29	14	1	13	1	3	1	1	—
4. S. C.	6	—	3	2	1	—	—	—	1
5. Sundhi	1	—	—	—	1	—	—	—	—
Sub-Total	47	16	7	15	9	3	1	3	5
Tribal									
1. Bhumia	17	3	3	—	—	2	1	2	—
2. Gadava	21	9	5	7	—	—	1	1	—
3. Porja	23	8	5	9	1	1	2	2	—
Sub-Total	61	20	13	27	1	3	4	5	—
Grand-Total	108	36	20	42	10	6	5	8	5

Appendix—5 B

CLUSTER III (UNSUCCESSFUL) :-

Castes	Total No. of house- holds	Total No. of donors	Total No. of donees	Total No. of non- donors	Total No. of Land- less	No. of sample donors	No. of sample donees	No. of sample non- donors	No. of sample landless households
<i>Tribal</i>									
Bhumia	71	19	1	45	6	5	-	8	-
Kamar	1	-	-	1	-	-	1	-	-
Parja	23	-	-	20	3	-	-	4	3
Sub-Total	95	19	1	66	9	5	1	12	3
<i>Non-Tribal</i>									
Scheduled castes	15	-	8	-	7	-	4	-	2
Grand Total :	110	19	9	66	16	5	5	12	5

Appendix—6 A

CLUSTER IV (SUCCESSFUL):—

Castes	Total No. of House-holds	Donors	Donees	Land Landless Sahukars		Sample donors donees		Sample Land owning non-house-holds donors	
				owning non-donors	House-holds	donors	donees	owning non-donors	house-holds
Non-Tribal									
Kamar	10	-	9	-	1	-	-	-	-
Lohar	5	-	3	-	2	-	3	-	1
Mali	27	16	16	2	2	2	1	2	1
S. C.	5	-	2	2	1	2	2	2	1
Sub-Total	47	16	15	10	4	2	4	3	2
Tribal									
Dora	8	-	6	-	2	-	1	-	2
Porja	39	13	18	-	4	4	2	2	1
Sub-Total	47	13	24	4	6	4	3	2	3
Grand-Total	94	29	39	14	10	2	7	5	5

Appendix—6 B

CLUSTER IV (UNSUCCESSFUL) :—

Castes	Total No. of House- holds	Total No. of donors	Total No. of non- donors	Total No. of land less	No. of Sample donees	No. of Sample non- donors.	No. of Sample landless households
<i>Non-Tribal</i>							
<i>Scheduled</i>							
castes	10	3	3	4	1	—	4
<i>Tribal</i>							
Kamar	3		3	—	—	—	—
Katia	23	17	2	1	4	—	1
Kumhar	1	—	1	—	—	—	—
Mali	4	3	—	—	—	—	—
Parja	49	29	10	—	1	—	—
Rona	18	11	1	—	2	3	—
Sub-Total	98	60	17	1	11	5	1
Grand Total :	108	63	20	5	12	5	5

Appendix-7 A

CLUSTER V. (SUCCESSFUL) :-

Castes	Total No. of House- holds	Don- ors	Land owning non- donors.	Landless house- holds	Sample donors	Sample donees	Sample land owning non- donors	Sample of landless house- holds.
Non-Tribal								
Karan	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Tribal								
Kandha	93	15	26	-	5	7	11	-
Grand-Total:	94	15	27	-	5	7	11	2

V. B. D. S. 13

Appendix 7-B

CLUSTER V (UNSUCCESSFUL) :-

Castes	Total No. of house- holds	Total No. of donors	Total No. of donees	Total No. of Non- donors	Total No. of land- less	No. of Sample donors	No. of Sample donees	No. of Sample Non- donors	No. of Landless House holds
<i>Non-Tribal</i>									
Blacksmith	1				1				
Scheduled castes	2		1		1				1
Sub-Total	3		1		2				1
<i>Tribal</i>									
Kamar	2				2				
Kandh	101	26	26	44	5	6	7	9	4
Kumuti	1				1				
Sub-Total	104	26	26	46	6	6	7	9	4
Grand Total	107	26	27	46	8	6	7	9	5

Appendix—8 A

FREQUENCY DISTRIBUTION OF HOUSEHOLDS ACCORDING TO LAND HOLDINGS

	CLUSTER I			CLUSTER II			CLUSTER III			CLUSTER IV			CLUSTER V			TOTAL		
	Don- ees	Land own- ing non- donors	Don- ees	Don- ors	Land own- ing non- donors	Don- ees	Don- ors	Land own- ing non- donors	Don- ees	Don- ors	Land own- ing non- donors	Don- ees	Don- ors	Land own- ing non- donors	Don- ees	Don- ors	Land own- ing non- donors	
Successful																		
Not exceeding 2.5	-	10	35	2	3	31	2	12	25	3	6	6	12	-	1	19	31	98
Over 2.50—5.00	1	2	38	8	4	18	16	4	14	3	-	4	-	-	41	28	10	115
" 5.00-10.00	-	1	-	5	1	6	11	1	2	15	2	3	10	10	10	31	3	21
" 10.00-15.00	-	-	1	3	-	-	3	-	-	5	-	1	2	-	-	13	-	2
" 15.00-20.00	-	-	-	-	-	-	3	1	1	1	-	-	1	-	-	5	-	1
" 20.00-30.00	1	-	1	2	-	-	1	-	-	2	-	-	-	-	-	6	-	1
" 30.00	5	-	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	5	-	1
Total	7	13	76	20	8	55	36	17	42	29	6	14	15	-	52	107	44	239

Appendix—8 B

FREQUENCY DISTRIBUTION OF HOUSEHOLDS ACCORDING TO LAND HOLDINGS

	CLUSTER I			CLUSTER II			CLUSTER III			CLUSTER IV			CLUSTER V			TOTAL	
	Don- ors	Land ees	Don- ors	Land ees	Don- ors	Land ees	Don- ors	Land ees	Don- ors	Land ees	Don- ors	Land ees	Don- ors	Land ees	Don- ors	Land ees	Don- ors
	ees	own- ing non- donors	ees	own- ing non- donors	ees	own- ing non- donors	ees	own- ing non- donors	ees	own- ing non- donors	ees	own- ing non- donors	ees	own- ing non- donors	ees	own- ing non- donors	ees
<i>Unsuccessful</i>																	
Not exceeding 2.5	11	6	20	2	9	17	—	2	27	7	2	1	—	12	20	19	77
Over 2.50—5.00	3	2	3	20	4	25	8	—	20	28	—	10	11	1	23	70	7
„ 5.00—10.00	7	—	9	23	—	10	—	—	12	20	—	6	10	—	10	60	—
„ 10.00—15.00		—	...	9	—	1	5	—	—	5	—	1	4	—	1	23	—
„ 15.00—20.00	2	—	...	2	—	—	5	—	3	2	—	2	1	—	—	12	—
„ 20.00—30.00	1	—	...	3	—	—	—	—	4	—	—	...	—	—	—	4	—
„ 30.00	1	—	...	1	—	—	1	—	—	1	—	...	—	—	—	4	—
Total	25	8	32	60	13	53	19	2	66	63	2	20	26	1	46	193	26
																	217

Appendix-9

No. of landless households not participating and reasons

	C1	C2	C3	C4	C5	Total
Successful Clusters						
No. of households not participated	4	1	3	2	-	10
Reasons :						
(i) No idea about the movement	2	-	-	-	-	2
(ii) No idea about the utility of the movement	1	-	-	-	-	1
(iii) Migrated into the village after Gramdan	1	-	-	2	-	3
(iv) Not present in village at the time of Gramdan	-	-	2	-	-	2
(v) Minor at the time of Gramdan	-	1	-	-	-	1
(vi) Nobody approached	-	-	1	-	-	1
Unsuccessful Clusters						
No. of households not participated	3	2	2	3	1	11
Reasons for not participating :						
(i) No idea about the movement	1	2	-	-	-	3
(ii) No idea about the utility of the movement	1	-	-	-	-	1
(iii) Migrated into the village after Gramdan	-	-	2	3	-	5
(iv) Not present in the village at the time of Gramdan	-	-	-	-	1	1
(v) Nobody approached	1	-	-	-	-	1

Appendix—10

Reasons for Donor's Voluntary Donation of Bhoodan land

Successful Cluster I	Yes	No.	No response
1. Persuasion of Bhoodan Gramdan workers	1	4	—
2. Convinced with the ideology of the movement	5	—	—
3. Inspired by saints like Vinoba	5	—	—
4. Because others were donating	—	1	1
5. Wanted to give land to the landless	5	1	—
6. To help village Development.	4	1	—
7. Landless must have a feeling of village attachment	5	—	—
8. For integrated development of whole village	5	—	—
9. To abolish exploitation of weaker sections	5	—	—
10. Gramsabha to plan for village development	3	1	1
11. Gramsabha would collect resources for the village	3	1	1
12. For community life in the village	3	1	1
13. For developing a feeling of cooperation, unity and belongingness	5	—	—
14. Afraid of forcible occupation of land	1	4	—
15. Fear of land legislation	—	5	—

REASONS FOR VOLUNTARY DONATION OF GRAMDAN LAND

SUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS	CLUSTER I				CLUSTER II				CLUSTER III				CLUSTER IV				CLUSTER V				TOTAL			
	Yes	No	Unab- le to say	No res- ponse	Yes	No	Unab- le to say	No res- ponse	Yes	No	Unab- le to say	No res- ponse	Yes	No	Unab- le to say	No res- ponse	Yes	No	Unab- le to say	No res- ponse	yes	No	Can, No say res- ponse	
1. Persuasion of Gramdan workers					3	1	-	1	6	3	-	-	3	3	-	-	4	-	1	-	16	7	1	1
2. Convinced with the ideology of movement					4	-	-	1	9	-	-	-	6	-	-	-	4	-	1	-	23	-	1	1
3. Inspired by saints like Vinoba					2	1	-	2	8	1	-	-	4	2	-	-	3	1	1	-	17	5	1	2
4. Because others were donating					1	2	-	2	1	6	2	-	-	6	-	-	2	2	1	-	4	16	3	2
5. Wanted to give land to the landless					4	-	-	1	5	-	4	-	6	-	-	-	4	-	1	-	19	-	5	1
6. To help village development					4	-	-	1	5	-	4	-	4	-	2	-	2	-	2	1	15	-	8	2
7. Landless must have a feeling of village attachment					4	-	-	1	5	-	4	-	3	-	3	-	2	-	2	1	14	-	9	2
8. For integrated development of whole village					4	-	-	1	5	-	4	-	3	-	3	-	2	-	2	1	14	-	9	2
9. To abolish exploitation of weaker sections					3	-	1	-	5	-	4	-	3	-	3	-	2	-	2	1	13	-	10	2
10. Gramsabha to plan for village employment					3	-	1	1	5	-	4	-	3	-	3	-	2	-	2	1	13	-	10	2
11. Gramsabha would collect resources for the village					2	1	1	1	5	-	4	-	3	-	3	-	2	-	2	1	12	1	10	2
12. For community life in the village					3	-	1	1	5	-	4	-	3	-	3	-	2	-	2	1	13	-	10	2
13. For developing a feeling of cooperation, unity, and belongingness					3	-	1	1	5	-	4	-	3	-	3	-	2	-	2	1	13	-	10	2
14. Afraid of forcible occupation of land					-	4	-	1	-	5	4	-	-	3	3	-	-	2	2	1	-	14	9	2
15. Fear of land legislation					-	4	-	1	-	5	4	-	-	3	3	-	-	2	2	1	-	14	9	2

* In Cluster I there was only Bhoodan

Appendix—11-B

REASONS FOR VOLUNTARY DISTRIBUTION OF BHOODAN/GRAMDAN LAND

UNSUCCESSFUL CLUSTERS	CLUSTER I				CLUSTER II				CLUSTER III				CLUSTER IV				CLUSTER V				TOTAL			
	Yes	No	Can not say	No response	Yes	No	Can not say	No response	Yes	No	Can not say	No response	Yes	No	Can not say	No response	Yes	No	Can not say	No response	Yes	No	Can not say	No response
1. Persuasion of Gramdan workers	3	1	-	1	13	2	-	-	4	1	-	-	8	3	1	-	6	-	-	-	34	7	1	1
2. Convinced with the ideology of the movement	5	-	-	-	15	-	-	-	5	-	-	-	11	-	1	-	5	1	-	-	41	1	1	-
3. Inspired by saints like Vinoba	5	-	-	-	12	3	-	-	5	-	-	-	8	3	1	-	1	5	-	-	31	11	1	-
4. Because others were donating	3	2	-	-	3	12	-	-	2	-	1	2	7	4	1	-	-	6	-	-	15	24	2	2
5. Wanted to give land to landless	5	-	-	-	13	-	1	1	3	-	2	-	10	-	2	-	6	-	-	-	37	-	5	1
6. To help the village development	5	-	-	-	9	-	6	-	3	-	2	-	7	-	5	-	-	-	6	-	24	-	19	-
7. Landless must have a feeling of village attachment	5	-	-	-	6	-	9	-	3	-	2	-	6	-	6	-	-	-	6	-	20	-	23	-
8. For integrated development of whole village	5	-	-	-	6	-	9	-	3	-	2	-	6	-	6	-	-	-	6	-	20	-	23	-
9. To abolish exploitation of weaker sections	5	-	-	-	5	-	9	1	3	-	2	-	6	-	6	-	-	-	6	-	19	-	25	1
10. Gramsabha to plan for village employment	5	-	-	-	5	-	9	1	3	-	2	-	6	-	6	-	-	-	6	-	19	-	25	1
11. Gramsabha would collect resources	5	-	-	-	5	-	9	1	3	-	2	-	6	-	6	-	-	-	6	-	19	-	25	1
12. For community life in the village	5	-	-	-	5	-	9	1	3	-	2	-	6	-	6	-	-	-	6	-	19	-	25	1
13. For developing a feeling of cooperation unity and belongingness	5	-	-	-	5	-	9	1	3	-	2	-	6	-	6	-	-	-	6	-	19	-	23	1
14. Afraid of forcible occupation	-	5	-	-	-	9	6	-	-	3	2	-	-	6	6	-	-	-	6	-	-	23	20	-
15. Fear of legislation	-	5	-	-	-	9	6	-	-	3	2	-	-	6	6	-	-	-	6	-	-	23	20	-

Glossary of Terms used in the Book

Adivasi : Aborigines

Amin : Land Surveyor

Bhoodan : Gift of land

Bhoodan Nivedak : A district level Bhoodan worker

Bhoodan Yagna : Land gift movement

Bhoodan Yagna Samiti : The Committee formed for the propagation of land gift movement

Donees : Those who are allotted Bhoodan-Gramdan land

Grain Gola : Place for storing grain

Gramdan : (1) Surrender of the ownership of land to the village Assembly.

(2) Gift of 1/20th land for landless people

(3) Donation of 1/40th of produce every year to the village Fund

Gramkosh : The village fund

Gram Sabha : Village Council

Gram Parivar : Village as a family

Gram Swarajya : Village self government

Harijans : A down-trodden caste in India

Lac : One hundred thousand

Naxalite : Marxist Leninist group of communists who initiated its violent activities from Naxalbari

Padyatra : Walking on foot

Panchayat : A Committee formed of the villagers

Pattas : Title deeds

Prabandh Samiti : The Executive Committee

Prakashan : Publication

Prakhanddan : Gift of at least 80% revenue villages in a Block in Gramdan

Prapti : Declaration of Gramdan

Pushti : Confirmation of Gramdan

Sahukar : A money lender

Sangh : Federation, Organisation

Sarva Seva Sangh : Central voluntary organization for conducting Gram Swarajya movement

Sarvodaya : Uplift of all—the philosophy of Mahatma Gandhi

Satyagrah : Passive resistance offered to uphold truth

Scheduled Castes : Untouchable Castes (abolished by law socially so even now)

Scheduled Tribes : Aborigines

Shanti Sena : Peace Brigade

Shri Chaitanya : A great Indian religious preacher

Sulabh Gramdan : A simple workable formula of Gramdan

Tehsil : An administrative subdivision of a district

Tehsildar : Sub-Collector of revenue of a Tehsil

Vaishnavism : A sect of Hinduism

Zamindari : Permanent land settlement

Ziladan : Declaration of all Blocks as Prakhanddan in a District

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